

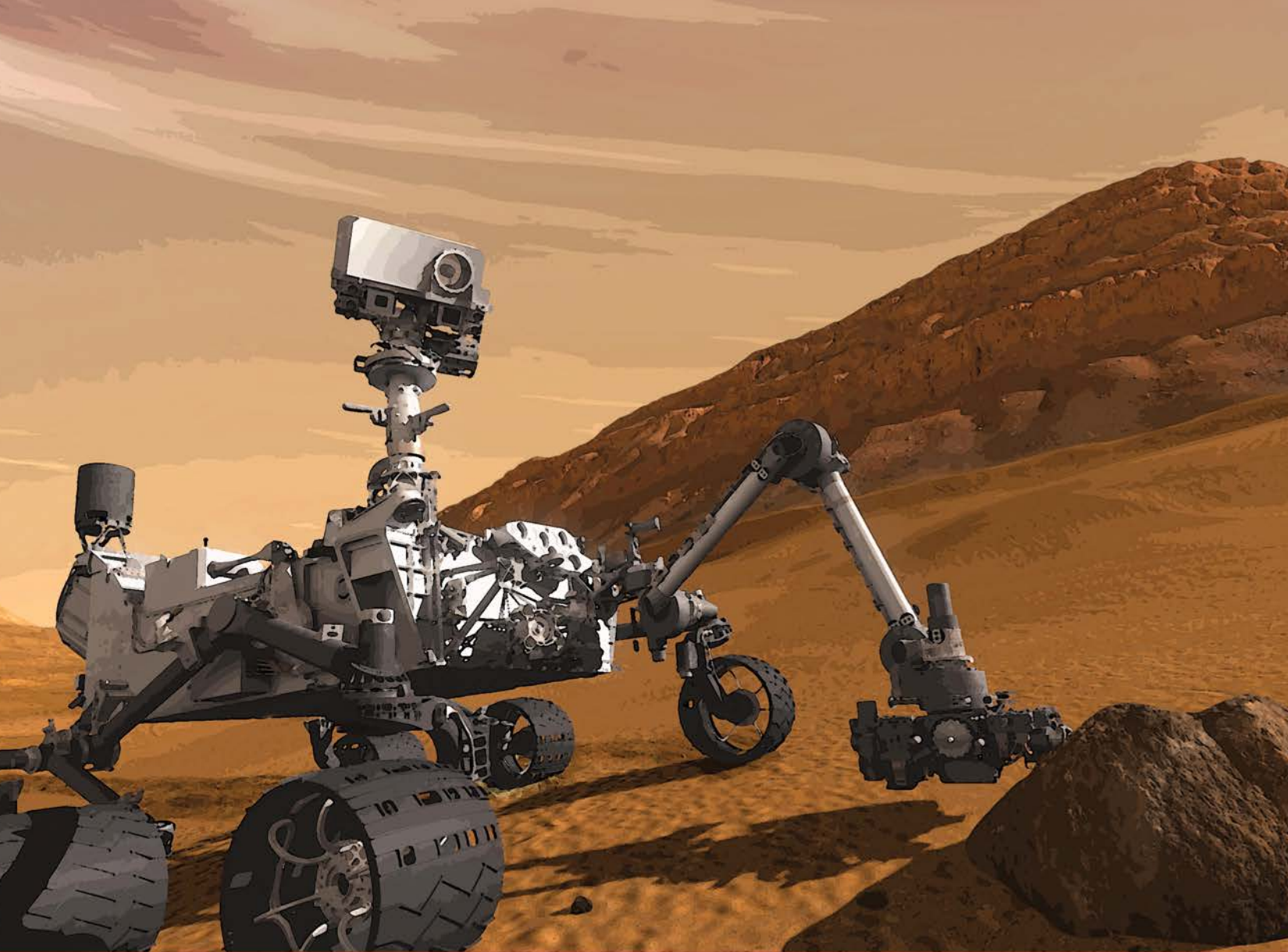


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RED DUST REBELLION

CURIOSITY CARD-BASED NON-PLAYER

RULES & REFERENCE BOOKLET

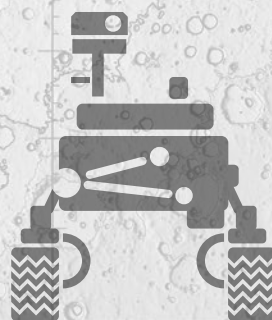
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8.1 OVERVIEW

Curiosity is the Non-Player (NP) system that may be used to replace any player Faction with an NP Faction. A deck of cards and several player aid tables guide the decisions made by each NP Faction. **Curiosity** is named in reference to the Curiosity rover, which landed on Mars in 2012 and is still operational over ten years later.

Curiosity is an adaptation of the Jacquard card-based non-player system first designed by Bruce Mansfield for **Gandhi**, and should be broadly familiar to anyone who has used previous iterations of this system. However, the NP CR rules required some new innovations due to their unique Asset card system, so special attention should be paid to how this NP Faction operates. It is assumed that you will already be familiar with the regular multiplayer rules for **Red Dust Rebellion** before using this system.

8.1.1 COMPONENTS

Curiosity Cards

Each NP Faction has six tarot-sized **Curiosity** cards that provide instructions for selecting and executing Operations and Special Activities.

Non-Player Game Aids

There are three Non-Player aid sheets: one foldout aid containing Priorities, Eligibility, and Event tables for all four NP Factions; and one single sheet aid containing Flashpoint Round instructions on one side and Dust Storm Round instructions on the other, and another single sheet aid containing specific Event Instructions on both sides.

Priorities Tables

Curiosity includes three types of Priorities tables: Space Selection, Move, and Pieces. Each Faction uses its own Space Selection Priorities table. All Factions share the Move Priorities and Pieces Priorities tables.

Eligibility Table

The Eligibility table determines how an Eligible NP Faction will act on the Current Event card.

Event Tables

There are three Event tables: Effective Events, Capability & Campaign Effects, and Event Instructions. The Effective Events table is located on the front of the Non-player Aid Sheet. The Capability & Campaign Effects table is located on the back of the Non-player Aid Sheet. The Event Instructions table is found on both sides of its own single aid sheet.

Dust Storm and Flashpoint Round Instructions

The Dust Storm and Flashpoint Round instructions guide the actions of each NP Faction during Dust Storm and Flashpoint Rounds.

8.2 GOLDEN RULES

8.2.1 GOLDEN RULES

NP Factions Follow the Rules (Almost)

NP Factions abide by almost all applicable **Red Dust Rebellion** rules, with a few exceptions:

- ▶ NP Factions never remove pieces from the map to Available when lacking pieces for an Operation, Special Activity, or Event.
- ▶ NP MG and NP RD do not track Resources. If an Event would transfer Resources from a player Faction to an NP Faction, instead just remove those Resources from the player Faction. If an Event would transfer Resources from an NP Faction to a player Faction, the player Faction instead just gains that number of Resources.
- ▶ Whenever Supply markers reach Phobos and would be converted into Resources, instead increase the NP MG Supply Total marker by one.
- ▶ NP CORP still tracks Profits, and will not be able to perform any action that requires it to spend Profits that they do not have.
- ▶ NP CR does not hold a hand of Asset cards, instead tracking its current 'hand' size with an Asset Total marker on the edge track. Any game effect that would draw or discard Asset cards instead increases or reduces Asset Total by an equivalent amount.
- ▶ Some NP Factions roll against an Activation Number (AN) to limit total spaces selected for Operations (8.5.4).

Skip Illegal Instructions

Curiosity will only tell you what to do, it will not tell you how to do it or even if its instructions constitute a legal move given the state of the board and available pieces. Always carry out **Curiosity's** instructions as much as possible, but if **Curiosity** ever gives you an instruction that cannot be carried out legally, just skip it.

Implement All Instructions Literally

Do not infer more to an instruction than what the text actually specifies.

Placing Friendly Pieces

When executing Operations, Special Activities, or Events that allow the acting Faction to place pieces in multiple spaces, NP Factions place pieces one at a time. In such cases, select the destination for each piece one at a time, using the NP Faction's Space Selection Priorities table. During Train, Logistics, and Rally Operations, NP Factions will place as many pieces as possible, following the directions on the **Curiosity** card and the limits of the given Operation. If multiple types of pieces could be placed, determine the pieces to be placed using the Piece Priorities table.

Removing Friendly Pieces

When given a choice, NP Factions remove pieces one at a time, from the space with the most pieces belonging to the affected NP Faction. Use the Piece Priorities table to select pieces to remove from each selected space, reading from the bottom up and right to left.

Operation/Special Activity to the Maximum Extent

NP Factions always execute a selected Operation or Special Activity to the maximum extent allowed, given the state of the board, available pieces, and Activation Number die rolls.

When in Doubt, Randomize

Whenever NP Factions need to select from among several options and supplied instructions have been exhausted, select one option at random.

Important: When given a choice to set EarthGov Confidence to EG+ or EG-, NP CORP will always set it to EG+ if Confidence is currently less than 4, otherwise it will set it to EG-. This most commonly happens when NP CORP performs House or Repair actions, but may also happen due to some Event effects.

See Important Curiosity Terms on back cover.

8.3 VICTORY

8.3.1 PLAYING SOLITAIRE

When playing solitaire against **Curiosity**, the player may only win during the final Dust Storm Round. NP Factions may win during the Victory Phase of any Dust Storm Round.

8.3.2 PLAYING WITH TWO OR THREE PLAYERS

When playing with two or three players, any Faction may win during any Dust Storm Round.

8.4 SETUP

8.4.1 SETTING UP NP FACTIONS FOR ANY SCENARIO

Create the **Curiosity** Deck

Each NP Faction uses six **Curiosity** cards marked with their Faction color and symbol. Shuffle the cards for any NP Factions being used into one deck, face up (with the  symbol showing).

Resource Cylinders and Asset Total

For any NP Faction being used:

- ▶ Set the NP MG Supply Total marker to 0 as its starting value.
- ▶ Set the NP RD Agitate Total marker to 1d3 as its starting value.
- ▶ Set the NP CR Asset Total marker to 3 as its starting value.

8.5 SEQUENCE OF PLAY

8.5.1 OVERVIEW

Generally, NP Factions make the same decisions that player Factions do. First, Eligible NP Factions determine if and how they will act on the Current Event card. The **Curiosity** card deck is used to select Operations and Special Activities and provide instructions to execute that action. Event tables guide an NP Faction's selection and execution of Events. Priorities tables are used to select spaces where NP Factions will act, how NP Factions move pieces, and which friendly and enemy pieces are affected by an action.

8.5.2 NP SEQUENCE OF PLAY & ELIGIBILITY TABLE

NP Factions follow the base game Sequence of Play and Eligible NP Factions choose from the same options as player Factions.

If the Church of the Reclaimer is an NP Faction, use this procedure to determine if they will 'discard' Asset cards to become 1st or 2nd Eligible. Before any Faction (player or NP) acts, if the Asset Total is greater than or equal to the number of Asset card discards required to become either 1st or 2nd Eligible, roll 3d6 and perform the following check to see if NP CR will 'discard' Asset cards to become 1st or 2nd Eligible:

- ▶ If the number of die results equal to or lower than the current Asset Total is at least equal to the Asset card discards required to become 1st Eligible, reduce the Asset Total by the number of discards required and NP CR becomes 1st Eligible.
- ▶ If not, and the number of die results equal to or lower than the current Asset Total is at least equal to the Asset discards required to become 2nd Eligible, reduce the Asset Total by the number of discards required and NP CR becomes 2nd Eligible.
- ▶ Otherwise play continues as normal.

Then, use the Eligibility table to determine the choice made by an Eligible NP Faction. If the NP Faction selects an Operation plus Special Activity, Operation Only, or Limited Operation, use the active NP Faction's **Curiosity** cards and the various Priorities tables to select and execute the Operation and any Special Activity. If the NP Faction selects an Event, execute the Event using the various Event and Priorities tables. If NP MG or NP RD selects Pass, there is no additional effect. If NP CORP selects Pass, they activate the Aldrin Cyler as though they were performing a Logistics

Operation (draw **Curiosity** cards until you find a card with Logistics and follow the instructions for selecting Transit). If NP CR selects Pass, increase their Asset Total by one.

If NP CR is instructed to check for an Asset Event, draw and reveal a number of Asset cards equal to the current Asset Total, then:

- ▶ If any drawn Asset Events are Critical and effective, randomly select one of those Events to perform.
- ▶ If no Critical Asset Event was performed, NP CR is 2nd Eligible, and any drawn Asset Events are effective, randomly select one of those Events to perform.
- ▶ If any drawn Asset Event was performed, reduce Asset Total by one, then the NP CR turn is complete. Discard all drawn Asset cards.
- ▶ Otherwise, discard all drawn Asset cards and continue down to the next line of the Eligibility table.

If the Asset card deck ever becomes empty, NP CR may not perform any Asset Events until the next Dust Storm Round (when the Asset discard will be shuffled back into the deck).



8.5.3

EXECUTING OPERATIONS & SPECIAL ACTIVITIES WITH *CURIOSITY* CARDS

Each NP Faction has six *Curiosity cards* that provide instructions for selecting and executing Operations and Special Activities.

Face Up and Face Down

Face up sides are identified by a  icon at top left. Except when acting as the active card, *Curiosity* cards should be face-up.

Setting Up the *Curiosity* Deck

At the start of the game and during the Reset Phase of each Dust Storm Round, shuffle together all *Curiosity* cards for each NP Faction into a single deck, face up.

Drawing *Curiosity* Cards

First, move the top card to the bottom of the deck (even if this top card matches the active NP Faction). Continue moving cards to the bottom, one at a time, until a card matching the active NP Faction is the top card. Always place cards on the bottom of the deck face up.

Reading *Curiosity* Cards

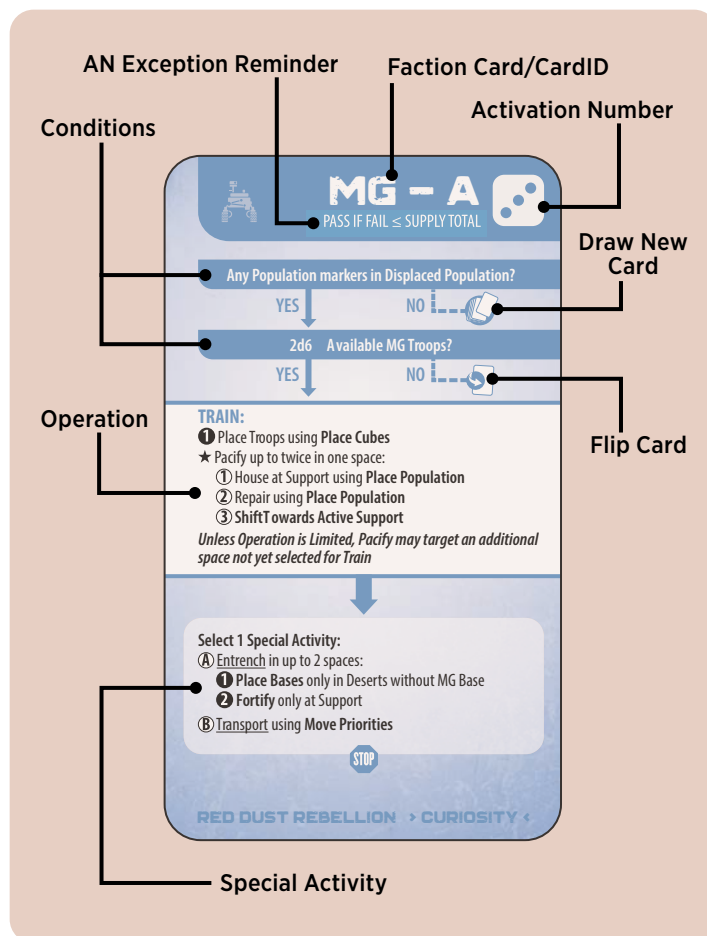
Start with the first box at the top of the card. If the condition in the box is true, follow the “yes” arrow; if it is false, follow the “no” arrow. Ignore spaces that could not be selected due to Raging Storms when checking conditions.

Drawing a New Card and Flipping a Card

If an arrow points to the  icon, **draw a new card**. If an arrow points to the  icon, **flip the card** to its face-down side.

Executing Operations

Execute each numbered instruction in order, as much as possible (i.e., execute instruction **1** in as many spaces as possible, then **2**, and so on—remembering that NP Factions follow all of the usual rules about space selection, etc.). Follow the instructions on the *Curiosity* card to select spaces, using the active NP Faction’s Space Selection priorities table when directed. Text in bold specifies the column of that NP Faction’s Space Selection Priorities table to use. Italicized instructions serve as reminders for the implementation of the preceding or following instruction. Starred instructions are executed immediately when they are reached on a card, and do not require any Activation Number rolls (8.5.4). Instructions that follow a red conditional are only executed if that condition is true. If there are no legal spaces for the selected Operation, draw a new *Curiosity* card to select a different Operation.



See 8.6 Operations Reference for detailed instructions of each Operation.

Executing Special Activities

Execute one Special Activity from the list, selecting the first possible in letter order (i.e., select **A** if possible, then **B**, and so on). Underlined text specifies the Special Activity. Within each Special Activity, execute each numbered instruction in order, as much as possible (i.e., execute instruction **1** in as many spaces as possible, then **2**, and so on – remembering that NP Factions follow all of the usual rules about space selection, etc.). Text in bold specifies the column of the Space Selection Priorities table to use when selecting spaces if multiple spaces could be selected within the instructions given on the card. If a Special Activity cannot be executed, or its red condition is not true, skip it and execute the next one. If no Special Activity can be executed, select either Operation Only (if still available), or select Operation and Special Activity without performing any Special Activity. See 8.7 Special Activities Reference for detailed instructions of each Special Activity.

Haboobs, Loops, and Edge Cases

Before executing any Special Activity for an NP Faction, check that the accompanying Operation can be performed (including during a Haboob); if it cannot, draw a new **Curiosity** card to select a different Operation and Special Activity. In rare cases, a Special Activity may be performed that would preclude a legal Operation; in this case, skip that Operation and end the NP Faction's turn after placing their Eligibility cylinder in the Operation and Special Activity box in the Sequence of Play. If at any time, all **Curiosity** cards for a given Faction are drawn without finding a legal Operation for the NP Faction to perform, continue to the next line of the NP Eligibility table, or that NP Faction will pass if already at the bottom of the table.

8.5.4 ACTIVATION NUMBERS

The total number of spaces that NP Factions select for Operations are sometimes limited by an Activation Number. Activation Numbers are found on the upper right of some **Curiosity** cards and indicated by a die icon; that number is used for all Operations on that side of the card. Do not make Activation Number rolls when executing free Operations granted by Events.

Checking the Activation Number

After executing an NP Operation in a selected space, roll 1d6. If the result is less than or equal to the Activation Number, the NP Faction will not select any additional spaces; implement any starred Operation instructions and then proceed to the next instruction box on the card. If the result is greater than the Activation Number, the NP Faction will select another space for Operation. Continue rolling as above after executing the Operation in each selected space until the Activation Number roll is less than or equal to the Activation Number, or there are insufficient pieces or spaces to continue the Operation.

Activation Number Exceptions

NP Factions do not make Activation Number rolls in several situations:

- ▶ All NP CORP Operations.
- ▶ After NP RD Rally that places Bases.
- ▶ After NP CR Rally that places Bases.
- ▶ After NP CR Travel that selects Wilderness.
- ▶ After the first space selected for all NP CR Operations (including Limited Operations). This means that NP CR will typically select at least two spaces for all Operations.

▶ Only if CORP is player-controlled: NP CR Rally that upgrades Bases in Deserts.

▶ Free Operations granted by Events.

Note: these instructions on the **Curiosity** cards are numbered with a black-on-white numeral as a reminder.

NP MG and NP CR Failed AN Rolls

NP MG and NP CR may treat some failed Activation Number rolls as successes:

- ▶ After NP MG fails an Activation Number roll, if the die result was less than or equal to the current Supply Total, instead reduce Supply Total by one and treat the result as a success.
- ▶ After NP CR fails an Activation Number roll during a non-Limited Operation, if the die result was less than or equal to the current Asset Total, instead reduce Asset Total by one and treat the result as a success.

NP CR Limited Operations

When performing a Limited Operation, NP CR will make Activation Number rolls as normal, but automatically stops after selecting a fifth space for the Operation. This means NP CR Limited Operations will typically select a minimum of two spaces and a maximum of five spaces. NP CR will then 'draw an Asset card' as usual, increasing the Asset Total by one.

Additional Final Actions

MG Train, CORP Logistics, COIN Secure and Recon, RD Rally, and RD Campaign Operations each potentially allow one additional action executed at the conclusion of the Operation, even after failing an Activation Number roll:

- ▶ NP MG will attempt to Pacify at the end of a Train Operation, potentially in a space that has not yet been selected for Train.
- ▶ NP CORP will place Security at Bases with fewer than four cubes at the end of a Logistics Operation (at the usual cost of 1 Profit per Security placed).
- ▶ NP MG and NP CORP will sometimes place Bases, House, or Repair at the end of a Secure or Recon Operation.
- ▶ NP RD will flip one Base in a Desert to Dug-In at the end of a Rally Operation.
- ▶ NP RD will play the first drawn Campaign card during Campaign Operations.

Resources

NP Factions do not track or spend Resources.

8.5.5 EXECUTING EVENTS

Critical Events

Events marked with a ★ symbol under the Faction icon are Critical for that Faction. Critical Asset Events are also marked with a ★ symbol. An NP Faction will always perform an effective Critical Event if it is eligible to do so, and will try to prevent other Factions (including player Factions) from executing their own Critical Events. A single Event may be Critical for multiple Factions.

Not Performed Events

Events marked with a ⓪ symbol under the Faction icon are Not Performed by that NP Faction. A Non-Player Faction will never perform an Event that is marked Not Performed for it. A single Event may be Not Performed for multiple NP Factions.

Performed Events

If an Event does not have any additional symbol below the Faction icon then it is Performed for that NP Faction. A Non-Player Faction will only execute a Performed Event if it is 2nd Eligible.

Event Tables

There are three Event tables: Effective Events, Event Instructions, and Capability & Campaign Effects. The Effective Events table lists the types of Event actions that are effective for each NP Faction. When given a choice, NP Factions only execute actions that are effective, and will not execute an Event with no effective options. The Event Instructions table gives specific instructions for executing certain Events and should be checked when any Event is executed by an NP Faction (although not every Event has additional instructions). The Capabilities & Campaign Effects table specifies the effects of some CR Capability and RD Campaign cards on NP Factions (most are self-explanatory and do not require any additional instructions).

Events Executed by 1st and 2nd Eligible NP Factions

A 1st Eligible NP Faction will execute an Event (including Asset Events for NP CR) if it is marked Critical for the acting NP Faction and, if executed, would result in one or more of the effects listed for the acting NP Faction on the Effective Events table. A 2nd Eligible NP Faction will execute an Event (including Asset Events for NP CR) if it is either Critical or Performed for the acting NP Faction and, if executed, would result in one or more of the effects listed for the acting NP Faction on the Effective Events

table. If NP CR executes an Asset Event, reduce Asset Total by one and then discard all drawn Asset cards.

Event Instructions

Some Events require additional instructions to guide NP Faction play, which can be found on the Event Instructions table.

Unshaded or Shaded?

Unless otherwise noted on the Event Instructions table, NP MG and NP CORP will always select the unshaded Event text, while NP RD and NP CR will always select the shaded Event text.

Place Friendly, Remove Enemy

When given a choice, NP Factions only place friendly pieces and only remove enemy pieces.

Selecting Spaces

Select spaces using the column of the active NP Faction's Space Selection Priorities that matches the effective Event action. If the Event includes more than one effective action, use the leftmost matching column.

Events that allow Operations or Special Activities

Draw a *Curiosity* card for the active NP Faction to select an Operation or Special Activity. If the Event specifies the Operation or Special Activity, draw *Curiosity* cards until a matching Operation or Special Activity is drawn (check both sides).

Faction Specific Reference: See 8.8 Events Reference for NP Faction-specific guidelines.

8.5.6 SPACE SELECTION PRIORITIES TABLES

There are four Space Selection Priorities tables, one for each NP Faction. Use an NP Faction's Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces for Operations, Special Activities, Events, and during Dust Storm Rounds. First determine the type of action the NP Faction will execute to determine the column to use on the Space Selection Priorities table. During Operations and Special Activities, use the column specified by the bold text on the *Curiosity* card. During Events, use the column that matches the effective action specified in the Event text. If an Event specifies more than one type of effective action, use the leftmost column on the Space Selection Priorities table. During Dust Storm Rounds, follow the instructions on the Dust Storm Round instructions sheet. During Flashpoint Rounds, follow the instructions on the Flashpoint Round instructions sheet.

Selecting a Space

When executing an Operation, Special Activity, or Event select each space one at a time:

- 1. Start at the top of the column and read down. For each row with a dot in that column, check its condition against all spaces that could be selected. Some rows contain conditional statements, marked by a red checkmark, that must be true for a red dot to apply. If no spaces meet the condition, skip that row and continue to the next. If only one space meets this condition, execute the Operation, Special Activity, or Event in this space. Otherwise,
- 2. If more than one space meets this condition, continue down the column to the next condition that is met. Continue to skip conditions that are not met or whose red conditional statement is not true. If only one space meets both the original condition and the new condition, execute the action in this space (as in Step 1).
- 3. Continue this process, checking each row below and applying all meeting conditions, until a single space is selected.
- 4. Repeat this process from Step 1 for each space to be selected.

Random Spaces

To select a space at random, assign equal probability to each candidate space and roll a die.

NP RED DUST		SHIFT TOWARDS ACTIVE OPPOSITION	PLACE POPULATION	PLACE OR DIG IN BASES	PLACE REBELS	MARCH DESTINATION	REDISTRIBUTE	AMBUSH	ATTACK	PLACE DAMAGE	REMOVE OR REPLACE
<i>Event: Execute the leftmost effective action</i>											
RD Base with no Hidden RD Rebel					•	•			•		•
not at Active Opposition		•			•	•			•	•	
✓ CR is player: CR Base or CR Control					•	•		•	•		•
most Population		•		•	•	•				•	•
✓ MG is player: most Support		•			•			•	•	•	•
most RD Bases					•						
vulnerable enemy Base					•	•		•	•		
no RD Control					•	•		•	•	•	•
most Opposition			•								•
most RD Rebels			•	•			•	•	•		
1-2 RD Rebels and room for an Available RD Base					•	•					
fewest enemy forces		•	•		•	•	•	•	•	•	•
select at random from remaining spaces		•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•
no legal Operation spaces: draw new Curiosity card		•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•

8.5.7 MOVE PRIORITIES TABLES

Whenever an NP Faction needs to move its pieces on the map, use the Move Priorities table. Read down the column that matches the active NP Faction, executing each instruction in a dotted row. Dotted rows with a red conditional only match if the condition is true. See 8.6 Operations Reference and 8.7 Special Activities Reference for detailed instructions of Operations and Special Activities that move pieces.

Step A

Select a destination space using the instructions on the Curiosity card, and if none, use the column of the active NP Faction's Space Selection Priorities table that matches the selected Operation or Special Activity. For NP CR Travel, this step instead selects an origin with the most moveable CR Rebels (see below), and not already selected as a destination.

Step B

Select an origin space within reach of the destination space with the most moveable pieces belonging to the acting NP Faction, and not already selected as a destination. Use the Move Priorities table (8.5.7) to check which pieces will be kept (and therefore not moveable) in each possible origin space. For NP CR Travel, this step instead selects a destination space using the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table.

Keep Pieces in Origin

Reading down the column that matches the active NP Faction, keep pieces in the selected origin as instructed by each dotted row. Instructions that follow a red conditional are only executed if that condition is true.

Move Pieces to Destination

Reading down the column that matches the active NP Faction, move pieces into the selected destination as instructed by each dotted row. Instructions that follow a red conditional are only executed if that condition is true.

Step C

After all moving pieces have moved from the first origin, check to see if additional origins or destinations will be selected. To select a new destination (or origin for NP CR Travel), return to Step A. To select a new origin (or destination for NP CR Travel), return to Step B. Note that NP Factions may need to pass an Activation Number roll to select additional spaces during Operations (8.5.4). NP MG and NP RD must typically pass an Activation Number roll to select additional destinations, while NP CR must typically pass an Activation Number roll to select additional origins.

Important: Unless otherwise specified by the current *Curiosity* card or Move Priorities table instructions, select moving pieces using the Piece Priorities table (within the constraints of the Operation, Special Activity, or Event being executed).

8.5.8 PIECE PRIORITIES TABLE

When an NP Faction needs to select pieces from among several different types, use the Piece Priorities table. When placing, moving, or using friendly pieces or removing, replacing, or Activating enemy pieces, start from the top and read down; within boxes, read left to right. When removing friendly pieces, start from the bottom and read up; within boxes, read right to left. Rows with a red conditional only apply if the condition is true.

8.5.9 FLASHPOINT & DUST STORM ROUNDS

During Flashpoint Rounds, follow the instructions on the Flashpoint Round instructions sheet for all NP Factions. NP CORP will never spend any Profits to move additional pieces from Earth to Transit. During Dust Storm Rounds, follow the instructions on the Dust Storm Round instructions sheet for all NP Factions.



Important: The rules that follow are written out versions of procedures found on the *Curiosity* cards and various play aids, and are intended to be used as a reference.

8.6 OPERATIONS REFERENCE

8.6.1 SELECTING AN OPERATION

Draw *Curiosity* Card

Draw a *Curiosity* card (8.5.3) for the active NP Faction to select an Operation.

No Spaces Selected

If there are no spaces that could be selected for the selected Operation, select a new Operation by drawing a new *Curiosity* card.

No Recon or March During Haboob

Ignore instructions to execute Recon or March Operations during Haboob. If necessary, draw a new *Curiosity* card to select a different Operation.

8.6.2 EXECUTING AN OPERATION USING *CURIOSITY* CARDS

Follow all Base Game Rules

Except for Resources (8.5.4), NP Factions follow all base game rules for Operations.

Numbered Instructions First

Execute each numbered instruction in order as much as possible before moving on to the next instruction. If an instruction cannot be executed, skip it.

Selecting Spaces

Use the active NP Faction's Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces for the Operation.

Operations that Move Pieces

Use the Move Priorities table to execute Recon, Secure, March, and Travel Operations.

Red Conditionals

Only implement an instruction following a red conditional if that condition is true.

Italicized Notes

Some instructions are followed or preceded by notes in

italics; these serve as reminders for the execution of the preceding or following instruction.

Activation Numbers

After executing the Operation in each selected space, make an Activation Number roll (8.5.4), unless this Operation is one of the exceptions (8.5.4). Once the Activation Number roll has failed, select no additional spaces for the Operation. Do not make an Activation Number roll after executing instructions numbered with a white circle.

Starred Instructions Last

Execute any starred instructions once all allowed spaces have been selected for the Operation.

8.6.3 CAPABILITY & CAMPAIGN CARDS

See the Capability & Campaign Effects tables for the effects of specific CR Capability and RD Campaign cards on NP Faction Operations.

8.6.4 NP MARS GOVERNMENT OPS

NP MG executes each Operation as much as possible, given available pieces and the state of the board. Follow all procedures for the selected Operation.

Follow the directions for each instruction, in the order given by the current *Curiosity* card.

NP MG Train Procedures:

Place Troops. Use the *Place Cubes* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces.

After all Troops have been placed (if any), perform up to two of the following Pacify instructions in one space, selected using the first applicable instructions, and possibly performing one instruction twice. Unless the Operation is Limited NP MG may select an additional eligible space for Pacify, if necessary to satisfy the Space Selection Priorities.

House. Use the *Place Population* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select one eligible space at Support and with room for Population.

Repair. Use the *Place Population* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select one eligible space with Damage.

Shift Towards Active Support. Select the same space already selected for House or Repair, or use the *Shift Toward Active Support* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select one eligible space if no House or Repair has been performed. Shift the selected space once towards Active Support.

NP MG Secure Procedures:

Use Move Priorities. Use the *Secure Destination* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select destination Labyrinths; and the Move Priorities table to select origins, pieces to keep in selected origins, and pieces to move into selected destinations. Select destination spaces with Hidden Rebels even if no additional MG pieces would move there. In each destination, Activate any Hidden Rebels as per Secure, after all moving pieces have entered each destination.

✓ **EarthGov Controller.** Move EG Troops and use Drop Pods as needed to fulfill Move Priorities.

House or Repair. Use the *Place Population* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select one eligible destination space without Opposition and either Damage or room for Population. House first if possible, then Repair if not.

NP MG Recon Procedures:

Use Move Priorities. Use the *Recon Destination* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select destination Deserts; and the Move Priorities table to select origins, pieces to keep in selected origins, and pieces to move into selected destinations. Select destination spaces with Hidden Rebels even if no additional MG pieces would move there. In each destination, Activate any Hidden Rebels as per Recon, after all moving pieces have entered each destination.

✓ **EarthGov Controller.** Move EG Troops and use Navigation Beacons as needed to fulfill Move Priorities and Activate any additional Rebels.

Place Bases. Place a Base in each destination that does not already have an MG Base.

House or Repair. Use the *Place Population* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select one eligible destination space without Opposition and either Damage or room for Population. House first if possible, then Repair if not.

NP MG Assault Procedures:

Select spaces using Remove. Use the *Remove or Replace* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces for Assault. Only select spaces where Assault would have some effect.

Assault to remove Rebel Bases. As above, except only select spaces where Rebel Bases would be removed.

✓ **EarthGov Controller.** Use EG Troops first, and then Bombard, as needed to remove any additional Rebel forces.

✓ **EarthGov Controller. Suppress using Remove.** Use the **Remove or Replace** column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select one space with EG Troops and Hidden Rebels.

Important: NP RD will only Attack after Assault if there is no Opposition in the space, and if doing so would not Activate the last Hidden RD Rebel in a space with an RD Base. NP CR will only Attack after Assault if doing so would not Activate the last Hidden CR Rebel in a space with a CR Base. If targeted by Suppress, NP RD will use the Place Rebels column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select one adjacent space to move its Rebels to, and NP CR will use the Place Rebels column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select one adjacent space to move its Rebels to.

8.6.5 NP CORPORATIONS OPERATIONS

NP CORP executes each Operation as much as possible, given available pieces and the state of the board. Follow all procedures for the selected Operation. NP CORP never makes Activation Number rolls, instead executing the selected Operation as much as possible.

Follow the directions for each instruction, in the order given by the current **Curiosity** card.

NP CORP Logistics Procedures:

Upgrade Bases. Use the **Place or Upgrade Bases** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select one space to upgrade a CORP Base to a Terraforming Base. If there are two or more Dust Storm Rounds remaining, continue selecting spaces to upgrade Bases, paying 3 Profit per additional Base upgraded (as usual).

Place 4 CORP Units on Earth. Per the Piece Priorities table, NP CORP will place all Security first, and only then begin placing SpecOps. NP CORP will never spend Profits to place additional pieces on Earth.

Resolve Aldrin Cyclor. Follow the normal procedure for resolving the Aldrin Cyclor, but do not move any Population from Earth to Transit. NP CORP will never spend Profits to move additional pieces from Earth to Transit.

Place Security. Use the **Place Cubes** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select any CORP Bases with fewer than four COIN cubes, and place one Available Security at each such Base (at the normal cost

of 1 Profit per Security placed).

NP CORP Secure Procedures:

Use Move Priorities. Use the **Secure Destination** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select destination Labyrinths; and the Move Priorities table to select origins, pieces to keep in selected origins, and pieces to move into selected destinations. Select destination spaces with Hidden Rebels even if no additional CORP pieces would move there. In each destination, Activate any Hidden Rebels as per Secure, after all moving pieces have entered each destination.

✓ **EarthGov Controller.** Move EG Troops and use Drop Pods as needed to fulfill Move Priorities.

Place Bases. Place a Base in each destination that has three or more cubes and no CORP Base.

House. Use the **Place Population** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select one eligible destination space with a CORP Base and room for Population.

Important: If House is performed, NP CORP will set EarthGov Confidence to EG+ if less than 4, or to EG- if 4 or higher.

NP CORP Recon Procedures:

Use Move Priorities. Use the **Recon Destination** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select destination Deserts; and the Move Priorities table to select origins, pieces to keep in selected origins, and pieces to move into selected destinations. Select destination spaces with Hidden Rebels even if no additional CORP pieces would move there. In each destination, Activate any Hidden Rebels as per Recon, after all moving pieces have entered each destination.

✓ **EarthGov Controller.** Move EG Troops and use Navigation Beacons as needed to fulfill Move Priorities and Activate any additional Rebels.

Place Bases. Place a Base in each destination that has no CORP Base.

House. Use the **Place Population** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select one eligible destination space with a CORP Base and room for Population.

Important: If House is performed, NP CORP will set EarthGov Confidence to EG+ if less than 4, or to EG- if 4 or higher.

NP CORP Assault Procedures:

Select spaces using Remove. Use the *Remove or Replace* column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces for Assault. Only select spaces where Assault would have some effect.

Assault to remove Rebel Bases. As above, except only select spaces where Rebel Bases would be removed.

✓ **EarthGov Controller.** Use EG Troops first, and then Bombard, as needed to remove any additional Rebel forces.

✓ **EarthGov Controller. Suppress using Remove.** Use the *Remove or Replace* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select one space with EG Troops and Hidden Rebels.

Activate SpecOps. Activate SpecOps as needed to remove any additional Rebel forces.

Important: NP RD will only Attack after Assault if there is no Opposition in the space, and if doing so would not Activate the last Hidden RD Rebel with an RD Base. NP CR will only Attack after Assault if doing so would not Activate the last Hidden CR Rebel with a CR Base. If targeted by Suppress, NP RD will use the Place Rebels column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select one adjacent space to move its Rebels to, and NP CR will use the Place Rebels column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select one adjacent space to move its Rebels to.

8.6.6 NP RED DUST OPERATIONS

NP RD executes each Operation as much as possible, given available pieces and the state of the board. Follow all procedures for the selected Operation.

Follow the directions for each instruction, in the order given by the current *Curiosity* card.

NP RD Rally Procedures:

Place Bases where 3+ RD Rebels and 1+ Hidden RD Rebel.

Use the *Place or Dig In* Bases column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces with three or more RD Rebels and at least one Hidden RD Rebel. Place a Base in each selected space.

Select spaces using Place Rebels. Use the *Place Rebels* column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces to place RD Rebels.

Flip most Rebels where all Active. Among all spaces with RD Bases and only Active RD Rebels, select spaces with the most Active RD Rebels. In each space, flip all Active RD Rebels to Hidden.

Dig In. Use the *Place or Dig In* Bases column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select one Desert space to upgrade an RD Base to Dug-In.

NP RD March Procedures:

Use Move Priorities. Use the *March Destination* column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select destinations; and the Move Priorities table to select origins, pieces to keep in selected origins, and pieces to move into selected destinations.

NP RD Attack Procedures:

Select spaces at Support. Use the *Attack* column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces with Support.

Select spaces with 3+ RD Rebels. Use the *Attack* column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces with 3+ RD Rebels and no Opposition.

Select spaces where all RD Rebels already Active. Use the *Attack* column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces where all RD Rebels are already Active.

NP RD Campaign Procedures:

Select spaces using Shift Towards Active Opposition.

Use the *Shift Towards Active Opposition* column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces for Campaign. If a selected space contains an RD Base and any Hidden RD Rebels, only select it for Campaign if at least one RD Rebel would remain Hidden.

Select first drawn Campaign card. Draw at most one Campaign card and put it into play.

8.6.7 NP CHURCH OF THE RECLAIMER OPERATIONS

NP CR executes each Operation as much as possible, given available pieces and the state of the board. Follow all procedures for the selected Operation.

Follow the directions for each instruction, in the order given by the current *Curiosity* card.

NP CR Rally Procedures:

Place Bases where 3+ CR Rebels and 1+ Hidden CR Rebel.

Use the *Place or Upgrade Bases* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces with three or more CR Rebels and at least one Hidden CR Rebel. Place a Base in each selected space.

Upgrade Bases in Deserts. Use the *Place or Upgrade Bases* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to

select Deserts to upgrade CR Bases to Conversion Centers.

Alternate Placing Rebels and Upgrading Bases. Use the *Place Rebels* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select one space to place CR Rebels, then use the *Place or Upgrade Bases* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select one space to upgrade a CR Base to a Conversion Center. Continue alternating placements and upgrades in this way until one cannot be done, then just do the other.

Flip most Rebels where all Active. Among all spaces with CR Bases and only Active CR Rebels, select spaces with the most Active CR Rebels. In each space, flip all Active CR Rebels to Hidden.

Important: Remember to increase Asset Total by one for each NP CR Base upgraded to a Conversion Center.

NP CR Travel Procedures:

Use Move Priorities. Select an origin with the most moveable CR pieces, then use the *Travel Destination* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select destinations; and the Move Priorities table to select pieces to keep in the origin and pieces to move into selected destinations.

Important: NP CR may move pieces from one selected origin to multiple destinations, and will select an additional origin for each successful Activation Number roll. If the Wilderness is selected as an origin, an additional origin will automatically be selected with no need for an Activation Number roll.

NP CR Attack Procedures:

Select spaces at Support or Opposition. Use the *Attack* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces with Support or Opposition.

Select spaces with 3+ CR Rebels. Use the *Attack* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces with 3+ CR Rebels.

Select spaces where all CR Rebels already Active. Use the *Attack* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces where all CR Rebels are already Active.

NP CR Preach Procedures:

Select spaces using Place Damage. Use the *Place Damage* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces for Preach. If a selected space contains a CR Base and any Hidden CR Rebels, only execute Preach if at least one CR Rebel would remain Hidden.

8.7 SPECIAL ACTIVITIES REFERENCE

8.7.1 SELECTING A SPECIAL ACTIVITY

Use the Current Curiosity Card

The *Curiosity* card and side that selected the Operation also selects the Special Activity (a few cards select the Special Activity first, and then may instruct you to flip the card to find an Operation).

Execute One Special Activity

Unlike instructions boxes for Operations, Special Activity instructions boxes often contain more than one Special Activity. Execute the first Special Activity on the list that will have an effect.

Red Conditionals

Only implement a Special Activity or instruction following a conditional if that condition is true.

No Spaces Selected

If there are no spaces that could be selected to meet the instructions for the chosen Special Activity, select the next Special Activity on the list. If this was the last Special Activity listed, the NP Faction does not execute a Special Activity.

8.7.2 EXECUTING A SPECIAL ACTIVITY

Follow all Base Game Rules

NP Factions follow all base game rules for Special Activities.

Number Instructions First

Execute each Special Activity numbered instruction in order as much as possible before moving on to the next instruction. If an instruction cannot be executed, skip it.

Selecting Spaces

Use the active NP Faction's Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces for the Special Activity.

Special Activities that Move Pieces

Use the Move Priorities table to execute the Transport Special Activity.

Red Conditionals

Only implement an instruction following a red conditional if that condition is true.

Starred Instructions Last

Execute any starred instructions once all allowed spaces have been selected for the Special Activity.

8.7.3 CAPABILITY & CAMPAIGN CARDS

See the Capability & Campaign Effects tables for the effects of specific CR Capability and RD Campaign cards on NP Faction Special Activities.

8.7.4 NP MARS GOVERNMENT SPECIAL ACTIVITIES

NP MG executes each Special Activity as much as possible, given available pieces and the state of the board. Follow all procedures for the selected Special Activity.

Follow the directions for each instruction, in the order given by the current MP MG *Curiosity* card.

NP MG Entrench Procedures:

Place Bases. Use the *Place Bases* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select Desert spaces without MG Bases.

Fortify. Use the *Fortify* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces at Support.

NP MG Petition Procedures:

To set EG+. If a paired MG Assault Operation removed more Rebel forces than COIN forces, and EarthGov Confidence is currently set to EG-, set it to EG+. Then place one Supply on Earth and reduce Profits by three.

✓ **3+ Rebels Activated: Place Supply.** If a paired MG Secure or Recon Operation activated at least three Rebels, place Supply on Earth and reduce Profits accordingly.

NP MG Transport Procedures:

Transport using Move Priorities. Use the *Transport Destination* column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select destinations; and the Move Priorities table to select the origin, pieces to keep in selected origins, and pieces to move into selected destinations.

8.7.5 NP CORPORATIONS SPECIAL ACTIVITIES

NP CORP executes each Special Activity as much as possible, given available pieces and the state of the board. Follow all procedures for the selected Special Activity.

Follow the directions for each instruction, in the order given by the current *Curiosity* card.

NP CORP Public Relations Procedures:

Repair. Use the *Place Population* column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select eligible spaces with Damage.

House. Use the *Place Population* column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select one eligible space with a CORP Base and room for Population.

Important: If Repair or House is performed, NP CORP will set EarthGov Confidence to EG+ if less than 4, or to EG- if 4 or higher.

NP CORP Exploit Procedures:

Exploit. Use the *Exploit* column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select eligible Populated spaces with CORP Bases.

NP CORP Raid Procedures:

Using Remove. Use the *Remove or Replace* column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces where Raid would remove any enemy pieces. When possible, use a Hidden SpecOps in the selected space before one in an adjacent space, then select a random adjacent Hidden SpecOps to move in.

8.7.6 NP RED DUST SPECIAL ACTIVITIES

NP RD executes each Special Activity as much as possible, given available pieces and the state of the board. Follow all procedures for the selected Special Activity.

Follow the directions for each instruction, in the order given by the current *Curiosity* card.

NP RD Redistribute Procedures:

Select spaces for Redistribute. Use the *Redistribute* column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select eligible spaces for Redistribute. If a selected space contains an RD Base, only execute Redistribute if there are at least two Hidden RD Rebels there. Increase Agitate Total by 1 for every 2 Resources that would be gained across all selected spaces.

NP RD Coordinate Procedures:

If a selected space contains an RD Base, only execute Coordinate if there are at least two Hidden RD Rebels there.

House. Use the *Place Population* column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select eligible spaces with room for Population.

Repair. Use the *Place Population* column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select eligible spaces with Damage. Reduce Agitate Total by 1 for each space selected for Repair, and do not select spaces for Repair if Agitate Total is 0.

In spaces with Active Opposition, remove two cubes first if possible, otherwise replace one cube.

NP RD Ambush Procedures:

Ambush. Use the *Ambush* column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces where Ambush could remove any enemy pieces. Set the Attack dice as necessary to remove any enemy Bases, then to place Damage if a selected space is at Support, and otherwise avoid placing Damage if possible (it may not be). Within these constraints, set the dice to remove as many enemy pieces as possible.

8.7.7 NP CHURCH OF THE RECLAIMER SPECIAL ACTIVITIES

NP CR executes each Special Activity as much as possible, given available pieces and the state of the board. Follow all procedures for the selected Special Activity.

Follow the directions for each instruction, in the order given by the current *Curiosity* card.

NP CR Purify Procedures:

Replace Bases. Use the *Remove or Replace* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select eligible spaces where an enemy Base could be replaced.

Replace Units. Use the *Remove or Replace* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select other eligible spaces.

NP CR Ransack Procedures:

Ransack. Use the *Ransack* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select eligible spaces for Ransack. If a selected space contains a CR Base, only execute Ransack if there are at least two Hidden CR Rebels there. Increase Asset Total by +1 for each Asset card that would be drawn.

NP CR Ambush Procedures:

Ambush. Use the *Attack* column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces where Ambush could remove any enemy pieces. Set both Attack dice to 1.

8.8 EVENTS REFERENCE

When given a choice, NP Factions execute effective Event actions according to the following guidelines:

8.8.1 NP MARS GOVERNMENT EVENTS

Choose to Increase

NP MG increases EarthGov Confidence as much as possible, and sets EarthGov Confidence to EG+ whenever possible.

Choose to Decrease

NP MG decreases Profits, Asset cards, and player Resources as much as possible.

Shift Toward Active Support

NP MG shifts Population towards Active Support.

8.8.2 NP CORPORATIONS EVENTS

Choose to Increase

NP CORP increases Profits as much as possible, and increases EarthGov Confidence or sets it to EG+ if EarthGov Confidence is lower than 4.

Choose to Decrease

NP CORP decreases Asset cards and player Resources as much as possible, and decreases EarthGov Confidence or sets it to EG- if EarthGov Confidence is 4 or higher.

Shift Toward Neutral

NP CORP shifts Population towards Neutral.

8.8.3 NP RED DUST EVENTS

Choose to Increase

NP RD increases Agitate Total as much as possible.

Choose to Decrease

NP RD decreases Profits, EarthGov Confidence, Asset cards, and player Resources as much as possible, and sets EarthGov Confidence to EG- whenever possible.

Shift Toward Active Opposition

NP RD shifts Population towards Active Opposition.

8.8.3 NP CHURCH OF THE RECLAIMER EVENTS

Choose to Increase.

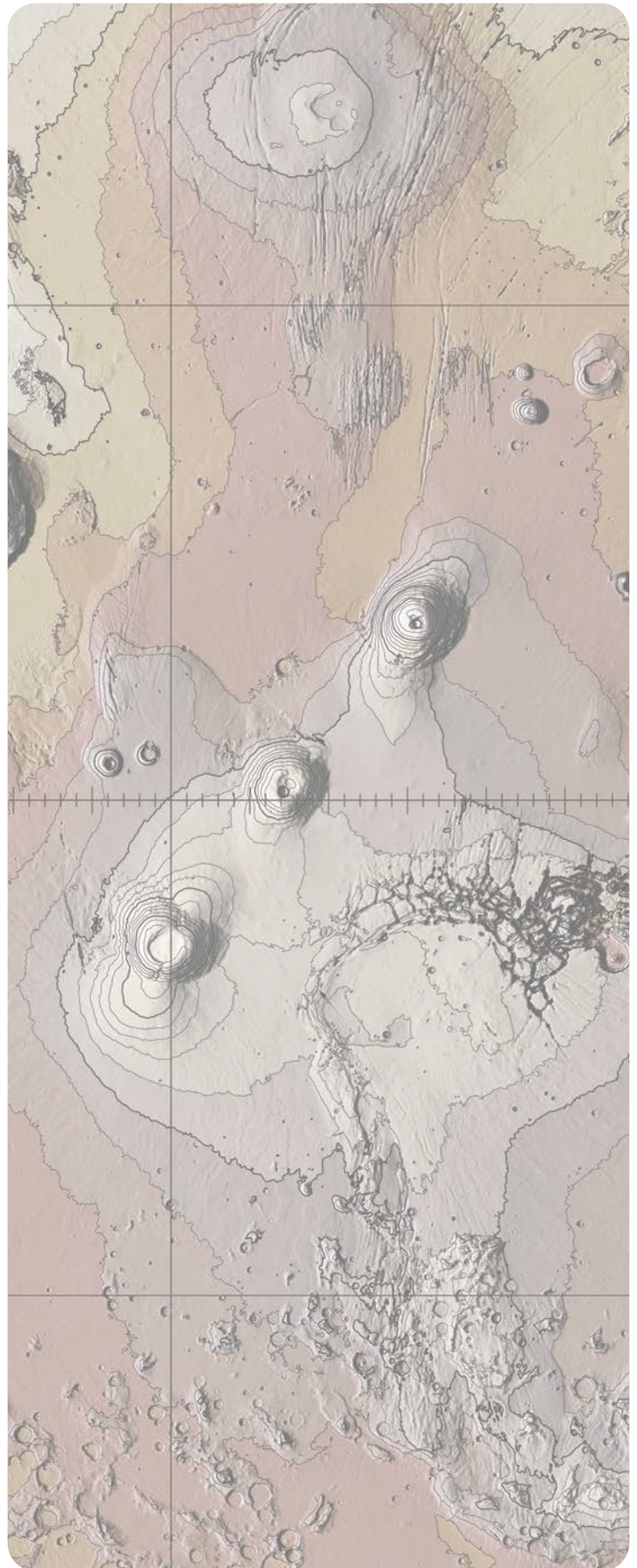
NP CR increases Asset Total as much as possible.

Choose to Decrease

NP CR decreases Profits, EarthGov Confidence, and player Resources as much as possible, and sets EarthGov Confidence to EG- whenever possible.

Shift Toward Neutral

NP CR shifts Population towards Neutral.



8.9 EXAMPLE OF PLAY

This example of play assumes that you are already familiar with the main multiplayer rules for *Red Dust Rebellion*. If not, you should instead begin with the Tutorial in the Playbook, and ideally play at least one game with other players before attempting to use the *Curiosity* Non-Player system. The example of play focuses on explaining how to use the Non-Player system, so it does not explicitly instruct you to perform routine tasks from the main rules, such as updating the victory totals for each Faction.

Set up the board for a new game as indicated in the main Rulebook, then create the Event deck as follows, from top to bottom: #11 **THE SECURITY OF MARS ACT**, #25 **NANO SURVEILLANCE DRONES**, #5 **SATELLITE NETWORK UPDATED**, #28 **REFUGEE CRISIS**, #45 **THE RED DESERT**, #12 **RED WEDNESDAY RIOTS**, #49 **DUST STORM**. Find and place **EARTH-BASED ENDORSEMENTS (RD8)** as the active Campaign card, and place Approaching Storm markers in Shepard and Pavonis Mons. All four Factions will be controlled by the *Curiosity* Non-Player system for this Example of Play (usually at least one Faction would be controlled by a human player). Remove the MarsGov and Red Dust Resource markers, then place the Supply Total marker at 0 on the edge track, the NP Agitate Total marker at 2 (usually this would be randomly set between 1-3 by rolling 1d3), and the NP Asset Total marker at 3. Do not deal out any Asset cards; the NP Reclaimer does not use a hand of cards like a human player would. Gather together the *Curiosity* cards for each Faction, keeping them in alphabetical order for easy reference (these would usually be shuffled together and drawn at random, but for the purposes of this Example of Play you will be instructed to find specific *Curiosity* cards). Finally, find the three Non-Player Aid sheets and place them nearby for reference.

Play begins as usual, by drawing the top card from the Event deck to be the Current Event (**THE SECURITY OF MARS ACT**, #11), and then revealing the new top card to be the Next Event (**NANO SURVEILLANCE DRONES**, #25).

CARD 1: THE SECURITY OF MARS ACT

NP MG are 1st Eligible on this Event, but before any Faction acts we need to check if NP CR will ‘discard’ Asset cards to become 1st Eligible (as indicated at the top of the NP Eligibility Table). To do so we roll three six-sided dice (3d6), comparing the result of each die to the current Asset Total (3) and the number of Asset card discards required to become 1st Eligible (currently also three). We roll two 2s and a 3, all of which are equal or less than the current Asset Total, and because the number of ‘successful’ rolls

is equal to the number of discards required to become 1st Eligible, NP CR ‘decides’ to become 1st Eligible (if only two rolls had been equal or less than three then they would instead have become 2nd Eligible). We reduce their Asset Total by 3, to 0, to indicate the Asset cards that they would normally have had to discard to do this.

CR Rally + Ransack

NP CR are now 1st Eligible, so we check the NP Eligibility Table to see what action they will choose to execute. The current Event is not marked Critical for NP CR, so they will not execute it, but we also need to check if they will execute any Critical Asset Events. To do so we would draw Asset cards up to the Asset Total, checking to see if each card is marked Critical, and NP CR execute the first such card (if any were drawn). However, since Asset Total is currently 0 we can also skip this line. The third line asks us to check if the Current Event is Critical for the 2nd Eligible Faction, which it is not, so we also skip it. The fourth line asks us to check if the next Event is Critical for the acting Faction **and** if they will definitely be 1st Eligible on it, which is never true for CR (here we always ignore the chance that they might spend Asset cards to become 1st Eligible). This brings us to the bottom of the 1st Eligible portion of the table, which indicates that NP CR will execute an Operation with a Special Activity.



CR - W
PASS IF FAIL ≤ ASSET TOTAL
MINIMUM 2 SPACES • LIMOP: MAX 5 SPACES



Any CR Base in a space with no Hidden CR Rebel?

YES ↓
NO → 

1d6 ≤ Available CR Rebels?

YES ↓
NO → 

RALLY:

- ① Place Bases where 3+ CR Rebels and 1+ Hidden CR Rebel
- ② ✓ **CORP is player:** Upgrade Bases in Deserts
Only make AN rolls after placing Rebels
- ③ Alternate Placing Rebels and Upgrading Bases
- ④ Flip most Rebels where all Active

↓

Select 1 Special Activity:

Ⓐ Purify:

- ① Replace Bases
- ② Replace Units

Ⓑ Ransack using Ransack

✓ **CR Base:** Only where 2+ Hidden CR Rebels

★ Increase Asset Total by 1 for every Damage

STOP

RED DUST REBELLION
> CURIOSITY <

We must now draw a *Curiosity* card for NP CR to determine which Operation and Special Activity they will perform. Usually this would mean first placing the top *Curiosity* card on the bottom of the deck, then continuing in this fashion until we reach an NP CR card, but in this case we will assume that card W is the first one that we find. The box at the top of this card asks us to check if there are any CR Bases in spaces with no Hidden CR Rebels, which

there are not, so we follow the “no” arrow down to the ‘redraw’ icon, place this card on the bottom of the deck, and continue finding until we draw a new NP CR card. The next NP CR card we draw is U, which first asks if there are

any Available CR Bases (yes), and then following the “yes” arrow down asks us to check if a roll of 2d6 is less than or equal to the number of Available CR forces. There are at least 12 Available CR forces (counting both Rebels and Bases), so we can assume this roll passes and continue following the “yes” arrow to find an Operation: Rally.

The first instruction in the Rally box tells us to place Bases in all spaces with three or more CR Rebels and at least one Hidden CR Rebel. There is currently only one such space, the Wilderness, so we replace two CR Rebels with a CR Base there. NP CR Rally Operations always skip Activation Number rolls until any Rebels have been placed, so we continue down to the next priority, which tells us to upgrade Bases in Deserts, but only if the Corporations are controlled by a human player. In this case they are not, so we proceed to the third priority, which is to alternate placing Rebels and upgrading Bases, starting with placing Rebels. To select a space to place Rebels we turn to the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table and consult the **Place Rebels** column.

NP RECLAIMERS									
		PLACE OR UPGRADE BASES	SHIFT TOWARDS NEUTRAL	PLACE DAMAGE	PLACE REBELS	TRAVEL DESTINATION	ATTACK	RANSACK	REMOVE OR REPLACE
CR Base with no Hidden CR Rebel			•		•	•			•
vulnerable enemy Base					•	•	•		•
no CR Control			•		•	•	•		•
most Bases					•	•	•		•
✓ MG is player: most Support			•	•	•	•	•		•
✓ RD is player: most Opposition			•	•	•	•	•		•
most Damage								•	
Neutral		•							
✓ CORP is player: Desert		•			•	•	•		•
most CR Rebels		•					•	•	•
fewest enemy forces		•		•	•	•			•
most Population		•	•	•	•	•	•		•
1-2 CR Rebels and room for an Available CR Base					•	•			
with Approaching Storm		•		•	•	•	•	•	
select at random from remaining spaces		•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•
no legal Operation spaces: draw new <i>Curiosity</i> card		•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•

Event: Execute the leftmost effective action

The first priority for Place Rebels is ‘CR Base with no Hidden CR Rebel’, which doesn’t apply so we skip it. The second priority is ‘vulnerable enemy Base’, of which there are several options: the enemy Bases in Tharsis Tholus, Noctis Labyrinthus, Radau, Marth, Coronae Montes, and Hellas Chaos are all vulnerable, as they have fewer than four friendly units with them (the RD Bases in Alpheus Colles, Gandhi, and Sharma are also vulnerable, but these spaces are not valid targets for CR Rally as they have Opposition). To choose between these spaces we proceed through the next few priorities, narrowing down the choice of options as we go. ‘no CR Control’ and ‘most Bases’ apply to all these spaces, and the next three priorities only apply against player-controlled Factions. However, ‘fewest enemy forces’ only applies to Radau, so we select that space and place one CR Rebel there.

NP CR always performs Operations in a minimum of two spaces, and we just selected the second space for Rally, so we now need to make an Activation Number roll to see if NP CR will select any additional space. To do this we roll one six-sided die, and the roll ‘passes’ if the result is greater than the number indicated at the top right of the **Curiosity** card (in this case, 3). We roll a 4, so we will select an additional space, this time to upgrade a CR Base (if possible), using the **Place or Upgrade Bases** column of the Space Selection Priorities table. We can quickly determine that Ascræus Mons will be selected, with the most CR Rebels and the fewest enemy forces (New Córdoba has the same number of CR Rebels but more enemy forces). We flip the Base there to its upgraded side and, because CR would usually draw an Asset card, we increase their Asset Total by one (to 1).

The Activation Number roll again passes, so we will place Rebels in another space, this time selecting Noctis Labyrinthus (with a vulnerable enemy Base, joint fewest enemy forces, and the highest Population) and placing one CR Rebel there. The next Activation Number roll is a 1, which would usually fail, but because it is equal to the current Asset Total we instead reduce the Asset Total by one and select another space (this simulates the possibility that the CR ‘player’ might choose to discard another Asset card for Resources). We are back to upgrading Bases, so we flip the CR Base in New Córdoba (most Rebels) and increase the Asset Total back to 1. One more successful Activation Number roll places a CR Rebel in Coronae Montes (with a vulnerable enemy Base, joint fewest enemy forces, and two CR Rebels plus room for an available Base), then the next Activation Roll fails on a roll of ‘3’, so the Operation is complete.

NP CR is still able to execute a Special Activity, so we follow the central arrow on card U down to the Special Activity box. The first priority here is Purify, but as there are no spaces that could be selected for Purify (with CR Control and enemy forces) we continue down to the next priority, Ransack. The card indicates that NP CR will use the **Ransack** column of their Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces for Ransack, skipping any space with a CR Base and fewer than two CR Rebels. We can quickly determine that the two spaces selected for Ransack will be Coronae Montes and then Ascraeus Mons, both with the most Damage and most CR Rebels, so we Activate one CR Rebel in each and increase the CR Asset Total to 3 (one for each Asset card that would normally be drawn). The CR turn is now complete.

MG Limited Train

NP MG is 2nd Eligible, and we again check the relevant portion of the NP Eligibility Table to determine what they will do. The Next Event is not Critical for NP MG, 1st Eligible did not execute the Current Event, the Current Event is marked as Not Performed for MG, and they will not be 1st Eligible on the Next Event, so we reach the bottom of the table and see that they will perform a Limited Operation. We draw **Curiosity** card A, which first checks if there are any Population markers in Displaced Population (there are), then if a roll of 2d6 is less than or equal to the number of Available MG Troops. There are currently 12 Available MG Troops, so we can assume the roll is successful and proceed down the “yes” arrow to the Train Operation.

The first instruction in the Train box is to place Troops using the **Place Troops** column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table. CR is not player-controlled, so we skip the first priority in this column. There are several spaces not at Active Support that could be selected for Train, but only one without COIN Control, Coronae Montes, so we place four MG Troops there. The Operation is Limited and can therefore only select one space, so we skip making

an Activation Number roll and proceed directly to the starred instruction on card A, which instructs to Pacify up to two times in one space. Usually this could be any eligible space, even one not yet selected for Train, but in this case it has to be Coronae Montes, as the Operation is Limited. The first priority on the card for Pacify is to House, but that is not possible as the space has Damage. The next priority is to Repair, so we remove the Damage from the space and one Population marker from Displaced Population, then set the EarthGov Confidence marker to EG+. We cannot Repair again, so we proceed to the third priority, and shift the space once towards Active Support (to Passive Support). The MG turn is now complete.

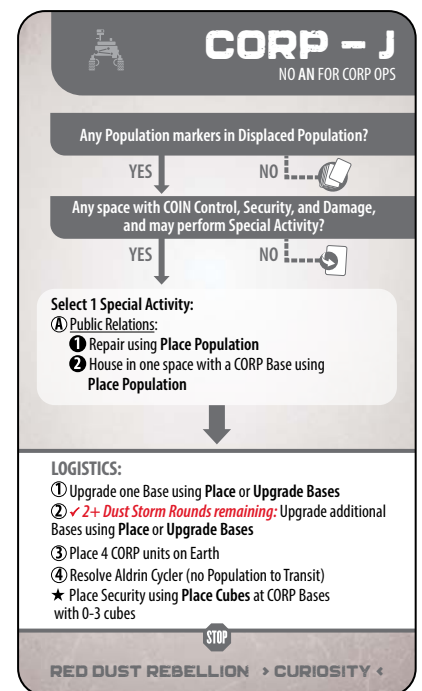
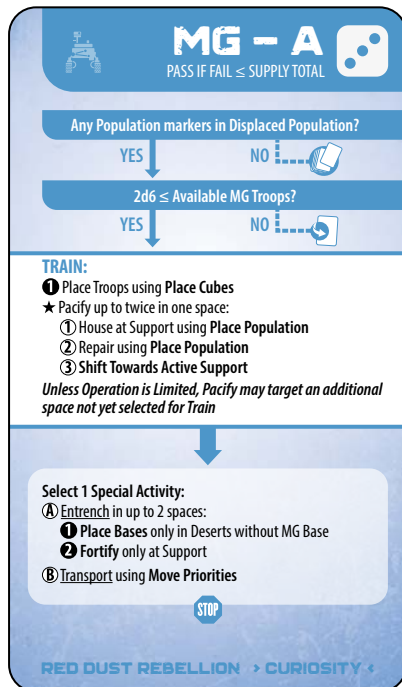
Reset Eligibility, advance the Next Event to become the Current Event, then draw the new Next Event and advance the Flashpoint marker two spaces.

CARD 2: NANO SURVEILLANCE DRONES

CORP Logistics

NP CORP is 1st Eligible, and neither the Current nor Next Event is Critical for them or RD, so they will execute an Operation with a Special Activity. We draw **Curiosity** card J, which first checks if there are any Population markers in Displaced Population (there are), then if there are any spaces with COIN Control, Security, and Damage, and if NP CORP can perform a Special Activity. All these conditions are true, so we follow the “yes” arrow down to the Special Activity box.

The only Special Activity listed here is Public Relations, which first selects spaces for Repair using the **Place Population** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table, then House in one space with a CORP Base, using the **Place Population** column if necessary to select an additional space. In this case there are only two spaces eligible for Public Relations and CORP Repair, Marth and Hellas Chaos. Public Relations can only be performed in a maximum of two spaces, so we do not need to check the Space



Selection Priorities. We remove the Damage and one Security from both spaces, remove two Population markers from Displaced Population, and increase Profits by four (to 4). House must then also be performed in one of these spaces, and we randomly select Marth as all priorities are the same for both spaces. We place the final Population marker from Displaced Population into Marth. Whenever Corporations perform House or Repair they can choose to set EarthGov Confidence to either EG+ or EG-, but NP CORP will always set it to EG+ if Confidence is less than 4, so it doesn't change.

Next we follow the central arrow down to find the Operation: Logistics. NP CORP never has to make any Activation Number rolls, and because this is not a Limited Operation we can just work down the list of priorities, performing every possible option. NP CORP will first upgrade one Base, using the **Place or Upgrade Bases** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select a Desert space with a CORP Base. Again, the priorities are the same for both Marth and Hellas Chaos, and this time we randomly select Hellas Chaos, flipping the CORP Base there to its upgraded side (at no Profits cost for the first Base upgraded). There are three Dust Storms remaining, so we will upgrade the Base in Marth as well, flipping it to its upgraded side and reducing Profits by 3 (down to 1). There are no more CORP Bases that can be upgraded, so we now place four CORP units on Earth, using the Piece Priorities table to determine which units to place. This indicates that we should place Security before SpecOps, so we place four Security on Earth. Next we select Transit and resolve the Aldrin Cyler, first moving everything in Transit to Phobos. MarsGov is a Non-Player Faction, so rather than increasing MG Resources when Supply reaches Phobos we instead increase the Supply Total marker once for each Supply marker (in this case, to 3), and due to the active Campaign card **EARTH-BASED ENDORSEMENTS** we also increase Agitate Total by the same amount (to 5). We then use the Piece Priorities to determine which pieces to move from Earth to Transit. The **Curiosity** card indicates that NP CORP will not choose to move any Population to Transit, so we just move two Satellites, two EG Troops, and one Security to Transit (NP CORP will never spend Profits to move additional pieces from Earth to Transit). Finally, NP CORP will use the **Place Cubes** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to place Security at any CORP Base with fewer than four cubes. This selects Marth first, with most Population, and placing one Security here reduces CORP Profits to 0 so they cannot place any additional Security. The CORP turn is now complete.

RD Limited Rally

NP RD is 2nd Eligible and will perform a Limited Operation, as the Next Event is not Critical for them, the Current Event is Not Performed by them, and they will also not be 1st Eligible on the Next Event. We draw **Curiosity** card R, and there are three RD Rebels in Sharma, Available RD Bases, and at least three Rebels in a space without Support (also Sharma), so they will execute a Limited Rally Operation. The first priority is to place a Base in a space with at least three RD Rebels and at least one Hidden RD Rebel. There is only one space that meets this condition, Sharma, so we replace two RD Rebels there with an RD Base. As this is only a Limited Operation we do not make an Activation Number roll and proceed to the starred instruction, to upgrade a Desert Base to Dug-In using the **Place or Dig In Bases** column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table. This selects Noctis Labyrinthus, the Desert with the most RD Rebels. We also skip the Special Activity box, so the RD turn is now complete.

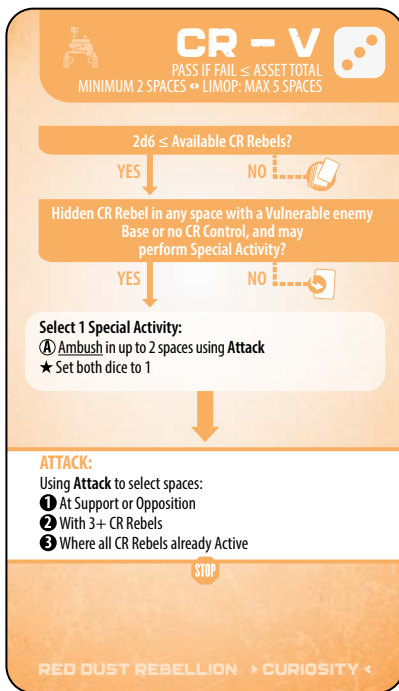
Reset Eligibility, advance the Next Event to become the Current Event, then draw the new Next Event and advance the Flashpoint marker two spaces.

CARD 3: SATELLITE NETWORK UPDATED

NP MG is 1st Eligible, but as NP CR is also eligible we need to check if they will spend Asset Total to adjust eligibility. This time we roll a '2', a '3', and '5'; only two results equal or less than the Asset Total, so not enough to become 1st Eligible. This would be enough to shift CR eligibility ahead of both RD and CORP on this Event card, but as CR are already 2nd Eligible they do not need to do this.

MG Event

The Current Event is Critical for NP MG, so they will execute it (there is also a note for this Event in the Event Instructions table, indicating that it is only Critical for NP MG if there are any Satellites in Orbit). NP MG and NP CORP will typically execute the unshaded effect of each Event, unless otherwise noted on the Event Instructions table. We increase EarthGov Confidence to 4, then move the two Satellites from Transit to Orbit. The MG turn is now complete.



vulnerable enemy Base or no CR Control, and whether CR are able to perform a Special Activity. They can perform a Special Activity and there are several such spaces, so we follow the “yes” arrow down to see that they will first perform a Special Activity: Ambush.

We are instructed to use the **Attack** column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select two spaces for Ambush (which must also have a Hidden CR Rebel, as usual). The first priority in this column, ‘vulnerable enemy Base’, narrows us down to just two spaces: Radau and Noctis Labyrinthus (the MG Base in Coronae Montes is no longer vulnerable, due to the additional Troops that were placed there). NP CR will therefore Ambush in those two spaces, Activating their Hidden Rebels and setting both sets of Attack dice to 1 (as instructed by the **Curiosity** card). This is enough to remove all the RD forces in both spaces, and to place a Damage in Noctis Labyrinthus (which also places a Population in Displaced Population).

The Ambush is complete, so we follow the central arrow down to the Attack Operation. This will again use the **Attack** column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces, but has some additional priorities listed on the card. The first of these restricts us to spaces with Support or Opposition, of which there are two possible targets: Tenzing and Coronae Montes. Both spaces have no CR Control, but Coronae Montes has the most Bases, so NP CR will Attack there first. We Activate the two Hidden CR Rebels there and roll the attack dice, resulting in a ‘5’ and a ‘2’. This places a Damage (and adds

CR Ambush + Attack

NP CR is 2nd Eligible, they will not (definitely) be 1st Eligible on the Next Event, and 1st Eligible executed the Current Event, so they will perform an Operation with Special Activity. This time we draw **Curiosity** card V, which again checks whether 2d6 is less than or equal to Available CR forces (it will, because there are 12 or more Available CR forces), but then asks if there are Hidden CR Rebels in any spaces with a Vul-

a Population marker to Displaced Population), then the ‘2’ result allows NP CR to remove two of the MG Troops from Coronae Montes. As the space is now Unpopulated it automatically becomes Neutral, so we also remove the Passive Support marker.

We then make an Activation Number roll, which is a ‘4’, allowing NP CR to select another Attack space, which will be Tenzing. We Activate the CR Rebel in Tenzing and roll two dice for an Attack there, this time resulting in a ‘1’ and a ‘3’. This result first places a Damage (also adding a Population marker to Displaced Population), then the ‘1’ result allows NP CR to remove two enemy pieces. Checking the Piece Priorities table, we can see that they will remove Security before MG Troops, so we send the one Security in Tenzing to Casualties, and remove one MG Troop to Available.

There are no other eligible Attack spaces with Support or Opposition, none with three or more CR Rebels, and no spaces (not already selected for Attack or Ambush) where all CR Rebels are Active, so NP CR will not select any further spaces for Attack and their turn is complete.

Reset Eligibility, advance the Next Event to become the Current Event, then draw the new Next Event and advance the Flashpoint marker three spaces, which will trigger a Flashpoint Round.

FLASHPOINT

Flashpoint Rounds are resolved as normal when using any Non-Player Factions, using the Piece Priorities table to determine which pieces will be placed, moved, or removed by NP Factions:

- ▶ The two EG Troops and one Security in Transit are moved to Phobos, then NP CORP will move four Security, one SpecOps, and one Population from Earth to Transit. NP CORP never chooses to spend Profits to move any additional pieces to Transit.
- ▶ The one Security in Casualties is returned to CORP Available Forces.
- ▶ EarthGov Confidence increases to 6, then we add two EG Troops, two Supply, and two Population to Earth.
- ▶ Terraforming increases Profits by a net total of three, to 3.
- ▶ The Approaching Storms in Shepard and Pavonis Mons are flipped to Raging, then we roll three times for new Approaching Storms. The first result is Arsia Mons, where we place an Approaching Storm, then

the second and third results are both Tereshkova, so we place a Raging Storm there and check the Piece Priorities table to see which unit NP Reclaimers will remove. MG Troops are higher priority than Rebels, so we remove one MG Troop from Tereshkova.

- There is no Attrition, but we do place one CR Rebel at the Conversion Center in New Córdoba.

We reset the Flashpoint track to zero, then play continues with the new Current Event.

CARD 4: REFUGEE CRISIS

RD Campaign + Coordinate

NP RD is 1st Eligible, and neither the Current nor Next Event is Critical for them or CORP, so they will execute

RD - T

2d6 ≤ Available RD Rebels?

YES → NO

RD Rebel in any 2+ Pop space not at Active Opposition?

YES → NO

CAMPAIGN:

- ① Using Shift Towards Active Opposition
- ✓ RD Base with Hidden Rebels: Only where 1+ RD Rebel would remain Hidden
- ★ Select first drawn Campaign card

Select 1 Special Activity:

(A) Coordinate:

- ① House using Place Population
- ② Repair using Place Population
- ③ Using Shift Towards Active Opposition
- ✓ RD Base: Only where 2+ Hidden RD Rebels
- ★ Reduce Agitate Total by 1 for each Repair
- ★ Remove 2 cubes before replacing 1

(B) Redistribute using Redistribute

- ✓ RD Base: Only where 2+ Hidden RD Rebels
- ★ Increase Agitate Total by 1 for every 2 Resources that would be gained

STOP

RED DUST REBELLION > CURIOSITY <

an Operation with a Special Activity. We draw **Curiosity** card T, which first checks if a roll of 2d6 is less than or equal to Available RD forces (it is), then whether there is an RD Rebel in any space with two or more Population that is not at Active Opposition. There are several such spaces, so we follow the “yes” arrow down to find an Operation: Campaign.

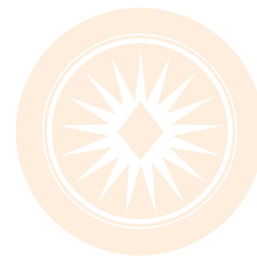
The Campaign box on this card instructs us to use the **Shift Towards Active Opposition** col-

umn of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces for Campaign. The first priority, ‘not at Active Opposition’, just rules out all spaces that are already at Active Opposition, in this case only Sharma. The second priority, ‘most Population’, quickly narrows us down to the first Campaign space, Shenzhou. We Activate the Hidden RD Rebel there, then shift it to Passive Opposition.

We now make an Activation Number roll, with any result greater than ‘2’ meaning that an additional space will be selected. We roll a ‘4’ and continue down the priority list, with Tereshkova, Shepard, and Gandhi now being tied, as they all have the next most Population and the fewest enemy forces. We’ve reached the bottom of the priority table, so we roll a die to select randomly and pick Shepard

(which has a Raging Storm but can still be selected for the Operation as it is a Labyrinth). We Activate one Hidden RD Rebel in Shepard and shift it to Active Opposition. At this point a human player would draw one Campaign card to choose from later, but we simply draw one and immediately put it into play, as the Campaign box on **Curiosity** card T notes that NP RD will always select the first drawn Campaign card. Draw **GENERAL STRIKE** (RD10) and put it into play now.

The next Activation Number roll is a ‘3’, so we select randomly between the two remaining spaces that we identified previously, and select Gandhi. Here there is an RD Base and Hidden RD Rebels, so NP RD will only perform Campaign if there are at least two Hidden Rebels (which in this case there are). Activate one Hidden RD Rebel in Gandhi and shift it to Active Opposition, but do not draw another Campaign card as we have already put one into play. The next two Activation Number rolls also exceed 2, so NP RD continues to Campaign in Tereshkova and then New Córdoba (which has the most Population of the remaining Campaign target spaces). We Activate the RD Rebel in both spaces and set them to Passive Opposition.



NP RED DUST

Event: Execute the leftmost effective action

	SHIFT TOWARDS ACTIVE OPPOSITION	PLACE POPULATION	PLACE OR DIG IN BASES	PLACE REBELS	MARCH DESTINATION	REDISTRIBUTE	AMBUSH	ATTACK	PLACE DAMAGE	REMOVE OR REPLACE
RD Base with no Hidden RD Rebel not at Active Opposition				•	•			•		•
✓ CR is player: CR Base or CR Control	•			•	•			•	•	•
most Population	•	•	•	•	•				•	•
✓ MG is player: most Support	•			•				•	•	•
most RD Bases				•						
vulnerable enemy Base				•	•			•	•	
no RD Control				•	•			•	•	•
most Opposition	•									•
most RD Rebels	•	•				•	•	•		
1-2 RD Rebels and room for an Available RD Base				•	•					
fewest enemy forces	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•
select at random from remaining spaces	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•
no legal Operation spaces: draw new Curiosity card	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•

The fifth Activation Number roll is a '2', so we now stop selecting spaces and the Campaign Operation is complete. Next we follow the central arrow down to the Special Activity box. The first Special Activity listed here is Coordinate, and the first Priority for Coordinate is to select spaces for House using the **Place Population** column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table. The first priority here is 'most Opposition', which narrows us down to Shepard, Gandhi, or Sharma. This is then further narrowed down to Shepard or Gandhi by 'most RD Rebels', and then Gandhi is ruled out because there is an RD Base with only one Hidden RD Rebel there. So we select Shepard as the first Coordinate space, Activating the second Hidden RD Rebel there to House one Population from Displaced Population (this also sets EarthGov Confidence to EG-). Shepard is already at Active Opposition, so NP RD may also remove two or replace one Security or MG Troops there. The Coordinate instructions on the **Curiosity** card indicate that NP RD will always remove two cubes before replacing one, but in this case there is only one cube in the space, so we replace it with an RD Rebel.

For the second Coordinate space we cannot select Gandhi or Sharma, as they both have RD Bases and only one Hidden RD Rebel, so we check the priority table again. Shenzhou has the next most Opposition, but the RD Rebel there isn't Hidden, so it may not be selected for Coordinate. Alpheus Colles is also not eligible as there is again an RD

Base with only one Hidden RD Rebel there, so we move on to 'most RD Rebels' and then 'fewest enemy forces', which brings us to either Daedalia Planum or Sinai Planum. We roll to pick randomly between these two spaces and select Sinai Planum. Activate the Hidden RD Rebel there, place a Population from Displaced Population, then shift it to Passive Opposition. The Coordinate Special Activity is now finished, and the RD turn is complete.

CORP Limited Recon

NP CORP is 2nd Eligible, and will perform a Limited Operation, as the Next Event is not Critical for them, the Current Event is Not Performed by them, and they will also not be 1st Eligible on the Next Event. We draw **Curiosity** card K, which first checks if there are any Available CORP Bases (there are), then if CORP Assault could remove a Rebel Base or two or more Rebels in one space. The only space where CORP could Assault is Shenzhou, where they would remove just one Rebel, so we follow the "no" arrow down to the "flip card" symbol and flip the card to its reverse side, KK. This first checks whether there are any Deserts without CORP Bases that could be reached by CORP units, which is true of all the Deserts (as Recon can move CORP units from Labyrinths with Spaceports to any Desert without a Raging Storm). So we follow the "yes" arrow down to the Recon Operation.

The Recon box on this card instructs us to use the Move Priorities table, then the first row on the Move Priorities table tells us to use the relevant column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to select a destination: in this case we use the **Recon Destination** column.

The first priority in this column, 'Rebel at CORP Base', does not apply to any Desert spaces. The next priority, 'CORP Base with 0-3 COIN cubes', applies to both Marth and Hellas Chaos, and none of the other priorities will decide between them so we roll to pick randomly and select Marth. Next we go back to the Move Priorities table,

CORP – KK
NO AN FOR CORP OPS

Any Desert without CORP Bases and reachable by CORP units?

YES

RECON:

① Using Move Priorities

✓ *EarthGov Controller: Moving EG Troops and using Navigation Beacons as needed*

★ Place Base in all destinations with no CORP Base

★ House in one destination with a CORP Base using Place Population

NO

SECURE:

① Using Move Priorities

✓ *EarthGov Controller: Moving EG Troops and using Drop Pods as needed*

★ Place Base in all destinations with 3+ cubes and no CORP Base

★ House in one destination with a CORP Base using Place Population

Select 1 Special Activity:

(A) Public Relations:

① Repair using Place Population

② House in one space with a CORP Base using Place Population

(B) Raid using Remove to remove Rebel forces

STOP

NP CORP

Event: Execute the leftmost effective action

	PLACE OR UPGRADE BASES	PLACE CUBES	SECURE DESTINATION	RECON DESTINATION	EXPLOIT	PLACE POPULATION	REMOVE OR REPLACE
Rebel at CORP Base			•	•			•
CORP Base with 0-3 cubes		•	•	•			•
COIN units < Rebel forces where CORP forces		•	•	•			•
most CORP forces	•					•	
Labyrinth with CORP > MG	•					•	
Conversion Center			•				•
most Population		•	•			•	•
✓ RD is player: most Opposition			•	•	•		
most Support	•				•		
Rebel Base			•	•			•
✓ CR is player: CR Base or CR Control			•	•			•
fewest Rebel forces	•	•	•	•	•	•	•
select at random from remaining spaces	•	•	•	•	•	•	•
no legal Operation spaces: draw new <i>Curiosity</i> card	•	•	•	•	•	•	•

which instructs us to select an origin space with the most 'moveable' forces, meaning forces that will not be required to stay in the space due to the 'keep' instructions that follow. In this case it is clear that Phobos has the most moveable CORP forces, as none of them will be required to stay there by any of the 'Keep' instructions. Finally we move down to the 'Get' instructions to determine which forces to move from Phobos to Marth.

The first 'get' instruction, 'get 1 acting NP Faction unit to destination', is already satisfied by the Security in Marth. The next two instructions refer to Hidden Rebels, so it can be skipped because there are none in the space. There is already COIN Control so we can skip the fourth instruction, and there are already more COIN forces than MG forces, so we can also skip the fifth. The sixth instruction, 'get 4 cubes to CORP Base', will require us to move two Security from Phobos to Marth (if NP CORP was EarthGov Controller we would have moved EG Troops first, per the Piece Priorities table). The next two instructions don't apply either, then finally we reach 'get 1 SpecOps to destination' and move the one SpecOps from Phobos to Marth. We then move down to row C at the bottom of the table, which directs us back to the top of the table to select a new destination (as Marth has COIN Control). However, because this is a Limited Operation we cannot select a new destination.

Instead we move on the additional starred instructions on the *Curiosity* card, which tells us to place a CORP Base in all destination spaces without one (but Marth already has a CORP Base), then to House in one destination with a CORP Base (but there is no room for additional Population in Marth, which is our only destination). So the Operation is complete and the CORP turn is over.

Reset Eligibility, advance the Next Event to become the Current Event, then draw the new Next Event and advance the Flashpoint marker four spaces.

CARD 5: THE RED DESERT

MG Assault only (no Special Activity)

NP CR again rolls too high to adjust eligibility, so NP MG remains 1st Eligible. The Current Event is not Critical for NP MG, but it is Critical for CR, who are 2nd Eligible, so NP MG will perform an Operation without a Special Activity ('Op only'). We draw *Curiosity* card D, which first checks if there are any spaces without COIN Control (there are), then if Assault could remove a Rebel Base, three or more Rebels in one space, or any Rebels at Support. The Active CR Rebel in Tenzing could be removed by Assault, so we follow the "yes" arrow down to the Assault Operation.

The first priority in the Assault box is to remove Rebel Bases, but there are no spaces where this is possible. The next priority applies only if NP MG is the EarthGov Controller, which they are, but as there are no EG Troops in spaces with Hidden Rebels it is not possible to use Suppress. The third priority instructs to select spaces using the **Remove or Replace** column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to select spaces for Assault. Under this there is a reminder that NP MG will use EG Troops or Bombard to remove additional Rebel forces if necessary (in this case it will not be).

MG - D

PASS IF FAIL ≤ SUPPLY TOTAL

Any space without COIN Control?
YES NO

Assault could remove a Rebel Base, 3+ Rebels in one space, or any Rebels at Support?
YES NO

ASSAULT:
1 To Remove Rebel Bases
2 ✓ **EarthGov Controller:** Suppress using Remove in one space with Hidden Rebels
3 Using Remove
✓ **EarthGov Controller:** Using EG Troops and then Bombard to remove additional forces

Select 1 Special Activity:
A ✓ **EG-** Petition to set EG+
B **Transport** using Move Priorities

STOP

RED DUST REBELLION > CURIOSITY <

The first priority in the **Remove or Replace** column is ‘Rebels at Support’, which in this case is only Tenzing. We select Tenzing as the first Assault space and remove the Active CR Rebel there. We then make an Activation Number roll and get a ‘3’, which would normally mean that NP MG does not select another space for the Operation. However, if the result of a failed Activation Number roll is equal or less than their Supply Total, then they instead reduce their Supply Total by one and select an additional space for the Operation (simulating the additional Resources granted to a human player by Supply). The Supply Total is currently 3, so we reduce it by one and select a second space for Assault.

There are no more spaces at Support with any Rebels and CR is not player-controlled, so we skip the next two priorities. The next priority is ‘no COIN Control’, which narrows us down to New Córdoba, Tereshkova, or Gandhi (out of the spaces where Assault would be able to remove any enemies). They are all Labyrinths, and New Córdoba and Gandhi both have the most Population and a Rebel Base, then Gandhi has the fewest Rebel forces so we select it as the second Assault space. MG Assault here just removes the one Active RD Rebel. RD are now eligible to Attack in response to the Assault, but NP RD will only choose to do so if there is no Opposition in the space, and if doing so would not Activate the last Hidden RD Rebel with an RD Base, so in this case they do not.

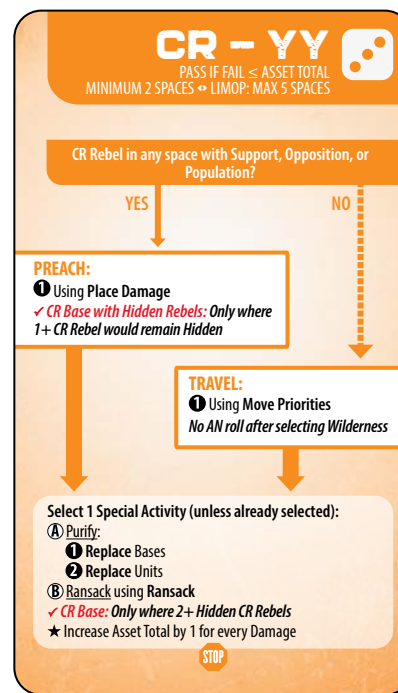
The next Activation Number roll will have to meet the higher target of ‘4’, as the additional Non-Player instructions for **GENERAL STRIKE** indicate that it increase NP MG Activation Number rolls by one after selecting spaces without Support. We roll a ‘5’, and so also select New Córdoba for Assault, removing only the Active RD Rebel there and leaving the Hidden CR Rebels and the CR Base untouched.

We roll a ‘3’ on the next Activation Number roll, which is also higher than the Supply Total, so the Operation is complete. NP MG will also not execute a Special Activity, in order to prevent CR from executing their Critical Event, so the turn is complete.

CR Limited Preach

NP CR will not be 1st Eligible on the next Event and cannot execute the Current Event. If their Asset Total was 5 or 6 then they would pass, as they would be guaranteed to discard Asset cards to make themselves 1st Eligible on the next Event. However, their Asset Total is currently just 3, so they will execute a Limited Operation.

We draw **Curiosity** card Y, which first checks if there are ten or more CR Rebels on the map (there are), then if they could



use Ambush effectively. As they are only performing a Limited Operation they cannot Ambush, so we follow the “no” arrow down and flip the card over to its reverse side, YY. This then checks if there are any CR Rebels in spaces with Support, Opposition, or Population, which there are, so NP CR will perform a Limited Preach Operation.

Preach just uses the **Place Damage** column of the NP CR Space Selection Priorities table, and because this

is an NP CR Operation we will always select a minimum of two spaces if possible. However, there is only one eligible (Populated) space for Preach, New Córdoba, so we do not need to check the priorities table and can just perform Preach there. This just Activates one Hidden CR Rebel and shifts the space to Neutral. As CR cannot select a second space for Preach the Limited Operation is complete, so we increase the Asset Total to 4 (due to Desert Efficiency) and the CR turn is over.

Reset Eligibility, advance the Next Event to become the Current Event, then draw the new Next Event. It is a Dust Storm card, so the Flashpoint marker does not move and neither Recon nor March may be performed during the next Event Round (due to Haboob).

CARD 6: RED WEDNESDAY RIOTS

CORP Secure + Raid

NP CORP is 1st Eligible, and neither the Current nor Next Event is Critical for them or RD, so they will execute an Operation with a Special Activity. The first **Curiosity** card we draw is M, which we flip to its reverse side MM because there are not any non-Terraforming CORP Bases in Deserts. This then directs us down to Recon, because there are Deserts without CORP Bases that are reachable by CORP units. However, due to the Haboob effect of the upcoming Dust Storm, Recon Operations are not possible, so we move this card to the bottom of the stack and draw a new one.

We next draw **Curiosity** card J again—it is possible to cycle through the whole **Curiosity** deck before a reshuffle, so you may end up drawing the same card multiple times. This time we flip the card to its reverse side, JJ, as there are

CORP - JJ
NO AN FOR CORP OPS

Any Labyrinth without COIN Control and reachable by MG units?

YES

SECURE:

- ① Using Move Priorities
- ✓ **EarthGov Controller:** Moving EG Troops and using Drop Pods as needed
- ★ Place Base in all destinations with 3+ cubes and no CORP Base
- ★ House in one destination with a CORP Base using Place Population

NO

RECON:

- ① Using Move Priorities
- ✓ **EarthGov Controller:** Moving EG Troops and using Navigation Beacons as needed
- ★ Place Base in all destinations with no CORP Base
- ★ House in one destination with a CORP Base using Place Population

Select 1 Special Activity:

- Ⓐ **Public Relations:**
 - ① Repair using Place Population
 - ② House in one space with a CORP Base using Place Population
- Ⓑ **Raid** using Remove to remove Rebel forces

STOP

no spaces with COIN Control, Security, and Damage.

There are several Labyrinths without COIN Control and reachable by CORP units, so we follow the “yes” arrow down to the Secure Operation. This again uses the Move Priorities table to determine which units to move, and the **Secure Destinations** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to choose where to move to. As this is an NP CORP Operation we

do not need to make any Activation Number rolls, so we will simply continue moving units until either all moveable units have moved or there are no more spaces that can be selected as destinations.

The first destination will be Shenzhou, where there is a Rebel at a CORP Base. Almost all of the ‘Get’ instructions are already fulfilled by the COIN forces here, except for ‘get 1 SpecOps’, so we move in the SpecOps from Marth. The next destination space would be Shepard, with the most Population, but as there is a Raging Storm there it cannot be entered, and CORP is not EarthGov Controller so they cannot use Drop Pods. The remaining reachable Labyrinths all have the same Population, three of them have Rebel Bases, and Sharma has the fewest Rebel forces (Gandhi has fewer Rebel forces, but it cannot be reached with Secure by any CORP units). The only CORP unit that can reach Sharma is the Security in Hellas Chaos, and none of the ‘Keep’ instructions apply to it, so we move it into Sharma (in order to try and get COIN Control), then Activate the RD Rebel there. NP CORP never needs to make Activation Number rolls, so we return to the top of the Move Priorities table and select a new destination, which will this time be New Córdoba (the only remaining reachable destination with a Rebel Base).

The first instruction is to get one CORP unit to New Córdoba, which could come from either Phobos or Europa, but not from Shenzhou or Marth due to the instruction to keep four cubes with each CORP Base. There are two Security on Phobos, so we move one to New Córdoba (via the Spaceport in Shenzhou and along the Maglev line). Next we need to get CORP units equal to Hidden Rebels in the destination, so we also move the second Security from Phobos. There are no more CORP units that can be moved from Phobos, but there is not yet COIN Control in New Córdoba, so the Move Priorities table instructs us to select a new origin space. This has to be Europa, as Shenzhou has already been selected as a destination and none of the remaining CORP units in March can be moved. We move the one Security from Europa to New Córdoba, again via Spaceport to Shenzhou and then along the Maglev line. There is an additional instruction to get one SpecOps to the destination, but the only SpecOps on Mars has already moved. We Activate all the Hidden Rebels in New Córdoba as part of the Secure Operation.

There are now no more moveable CORP units, so we move on to the starred instructions. These tell us to first place a Base in all destinations that have at least three cubes and no CORP Base, which is true of just New Córdoba, so we replace one Security with a CORP Base there. Next NP CORP will House in one destination with a CORP Base, which will be Shenzhou (with the most CORP forces and the most Population), so we place one Population from Displaced Population there (and we would also set EarthGov Confidence to EG-, if it wasn’t already, as it is above 3). The Secure Operation is now complete.

We now follow the central arrow down to find a Special Activity. Public Relations is listed first on this card, but as there are no Population markers in Displaced Population it would not be effective, so we move on to the second Special Activity, Raid. We will use the **Remove or Replace** column of the NP CORP Space Selection Priorities table to choose which spaces to select for Raid, bearing in mind that they must be with or adjacent to a SpecOps to be effective. There is only one SpecOps on the map, in Shenzhou, so we will have to select either Shenzhou or one of the adjacent Deserts, and there is a Rebel at the CORP Base in Shenzhou, so we can quickly determine that this space will be selected for Raid. We Activate the SpecOps there and remove the RD Rebel. It is not possible to select a second space for Raid, so the CORP turn is complete.

RD Event

NP RD is 2nd Eligible and will execute the Event. NP RD and NP CR will typically perform the shaded texts on Events, unless otherwise noted on the Event Instructions table. This Event does have additional instructions, but they just tell us to use the **Ambush** column of the NP RD Space Selection Priorities table to select one Labyrinth, then to draw an NP RD **Curiosity** card with Ambush instructions.



The only vulnerable enemy Base in a Labyrinth is the CR Base in New Córdoba, so we place two RD Rebels there and then find **Curiosity** card S for Ambush instructions. We can skip straight to the Ambush box, which tells us to set both dice to whatever values are necessary to remove enemy Bases, and then only to cause Damage if the space is at Support. However, it will be necessary to set both dice to '2' in order to remove the CR Base, so we do that. This first places a Damage (and also adds a Population marker to Displaced Population). We then consult the Piece Priorities table to check which four enemy pieces to remove. Security and MG Troops would normally be removed before CR Rebels, but in this case the CR Rebels are removed first because they are protecting a vulnerable Base, which also means that the CR Base is removed. The Event is complete and the RD turn is now over.

Reset Eligibility, advance the Next Event to become the Current Event, then we will pause to perform the Dust Storm Round.



CARD 7: DUST STORM ROUND

Dust Storm Rounds are performed as normal with any Non-Player Factions, except for some additional instructions that can be found on the Non-Player Dust Storm Round instructions sheet. Find this now, then proceed through the following phases:

Victory Phase

As noted on the Non-Player Dust Storm Round instructions, a human playing solitaire against three NP Factions cannot win until the final Dust Storm Round. This does not currently apply, and in any case no Factions have passed their victory threshold (although CR came very close). Supply Total is also reduced by one for every two Population markers in Displaced Population, but in this case there is only one there.

Resources Phase

Resources are not tracked for NP MG or NP RD, so we skip their steps. For NP CR we increase their Asset Total by the number of Asset cards they would draw, in this case to the maximum of 6. NP CORP gains Profits for Bases in Labyrinths as normal, increasing by four to 7.

Support Phase

NP MG first uses the **Place Population** column of the NP MG Space Selection Priorities table to House in as many spaces as possible, in this case just placing one Population into Europa (where there is the most Support, as Tenzing has Damage and so cannot be selected for House). Then we roll 2d6 to see how many Repairs and shifts towards Active Support they will perform, and we roll a three. If possible NP MG will Repair first, again using the **Place Population** column to select spaces, but there is no more Displaced Population so they cannot Repair. We then use the **Shift Towards Active Support** column to select spaces to shift, shifting Europa to Active Support and Shenzhou to Passive Support. Finally we increase EarthGov Confidence one step, to 8.

NP RD then Houses as much as possible and 'spends' their Agitate Total for Repair and shifts towards Active Opposition. In this case they cannot House or Repair as there is no more Population in Displaced Population, so they just spend four of their five Agitate Total to shift all three of Alpheus Colles, Sinai Planum, and Daedalia Planum to Active Opposition.

Redeploy Phase

Each NP Faction has additional instructions for how to Redeploy. We will not review these in detail here, but in this case they have the following effects:

- ▶ NP MG will move MG Troops to Shenzhou to exceed the CORP forces there, because there is Support and a CORP Base. We first move one MG Troop from Coronae Montes, which has the most MG Troops, but we cannot move any more without losing COIN Control there. Two more MG Troops are still needed to exceed CORP forces in Shenzhou, and Tenzing, Europa, and Tharsis all have the same number of MG Troops, so we randomly select Tharsis Tholus and move both MG Troops from there to Shenzhou. NP MG will not move any further Troops.
- ▶ NP RD will move one Rebel from New Córdoba to Gandhi (with room for an Available RD Base and the most Population), another Rebel from Daedalia Planum to Gandhi, and the Rebel from Sinai Planum to Alpheus Colles. NP RD will always keep three RD Rebels in each space with room for an Available RD Base (such as Shepard), and one RD Rebel in each Populated space without Active Opposition (such as Tereshkova and New Córdoba).
- ▶ NP CR will just move one Rebel from Ascraeus Mons to the Wilderness. NP CR will always keep three CR Rebels in each space with room for an Available CR Base (such as Coronae Montes), one CR Rebel in every space where they have one (such as Noctis Labyrinthus), and will never move forces that would change Control of a space.

Reset Phase

Perform the Reset Phase as normal, with the additional step of shuffling the **Curiosity** deck. If Agitate Total was at 0 it would be set to a roll of 1d3.

This example of play is now complete, but you can continue the game by selecting one of the Factions to play as and constructing the rest of the Event deck (add six additional Event cards on top of the second and third Dust Storm stacks). You should now be able to run the Non-Player Factions by yourself, but pay close attention to the **Curiosity** cards and the various tables on the Non-Player aid sheets, and check the rest of this booklet if there is anything you are unsure about.

Here are a few additional points to keep in mind:

- ▶ NP CR will sometimes check for Critical or performed Asset Events by drawing a number of Asset cards equal

to their current Asset Total. If an Asset Event is played, reduce Asset Total by one.

- ▶ When they are EarthGov Controller, NP MG or NP CORP will move EG Troops with Secure and Recon, and use EG Troops to remove additional Rebels with Assault. They will also use Satellites as necessary to allow Secure, Recon, and Assault to achieve the priorities on their **Curiosity** cards.

- ▶ Any NP Faction forced to move Rebels by Suppress will use the **Place Rebels** column of their Space Selection Priorities table to decide which adjacent space to move them too.

- ▶ NP RD uses the Move Priorities table for March, first selecting a destination using the **March Destination** column of their Space Selection Priorities table and then using the Move Priorities table to select an origin and determine which pieces to move.

- ▶ NP CR also uses the Move Priorities table for Travel, but first selects an origin with the most moveable forces, and then selects a destination using the **Travel Destination** column of their Space Selection Priorities table. They will also continue selecting new destinations until no more forces are able to move from the selected origin, and only then make an Activation Number roll to see if they can select an additional origin.

- ▶ NP MG will use Entrench to Fortify only in spaces with Support, and then will Fortify as many Troops as possible there.

- ▶ During NP CR Redeploy, if the Wilderness contains no enemy forces then NP CR will move one CR Base there from each other space with two CR Bases (moving regular Bases before Conversion Centers, as indicated on the Piece Priorities table).



NON-PLAYER DESIGN NOTES

I have now designed several iterations of the Jacquard card-based non-player system for different COIN volumes, and while each volume presents unique challenges, this one has certainly been the most difficult to design. Bruce Mansfield and Jason Carr's original work on the Jacquard system for *Gandhi* laid a solid foundation for future iterations, but designing a new version of this system is far from a 'plug-and-play' experience. Each COIN volume introduces new elements that require their own hand-crafted decision procedures, and each Non-Player Faction furthermore requires in-depth strategic analysis in order to curate a competitive and compelling player experience. It would not be too much of an overstatement to say that designing and developing a Jacquard system takes almost as much work as the multiplayer game it is intended to support.

In the case of *Red Dust Rebellion* there were numerous hurdles that needed to be crossed. The first and most obvious of these was how to handle the Church of the Reclaimer, who introduced the first major piece of hidden information into the COIN series. It was clear that the Non-Player Reclaimers would not be able to hold a literal hand of cards, but we still needed a way for them to track and spend virtual 'cards', as this is crucial to the dynamics of their gameplay (much more so than the Resource constraints that Jacquard typically abstracts into Activation Numbers for other Factions). With some help from Jason Carr and Adam Blinkinsop I was able to devise a plausible (and more importantly quick) method for checking whether NP Reclaimers would seize the initiative and when they would spend Asset cards to select additional spaces for Operations. This same method also served to track the additional spaces that NP MarsGov should be able to select when they are receiving a steady flow of Supply from Earth, without having to track all of their Resource expenditures. Additional hurdles soon appeared in the form of when and where to House or Repair, the special options available to the EarthGov Controller, and other minutiae unique to this volume, but we were now well underway and testing could begin in earnest.

Producing a game of this size is always a team effort, and I would especially like to thank Aaron Jacobson, mango-feet, Mike Macleod, Prabha Pillay, and Yann de Villeneuve for their extensive and tireless playtesting contributions during the final few months of development. It was a great pleasure to play several games with some of them and with other testers, and it would not have been possible to finish *Red Dust Rebellion* without them. An extra special

thanks goes out to Mike Macleod and Prabha Pillay for diligently checking and rechecking the Non-Player Example of Play—any remaining errors are my own!

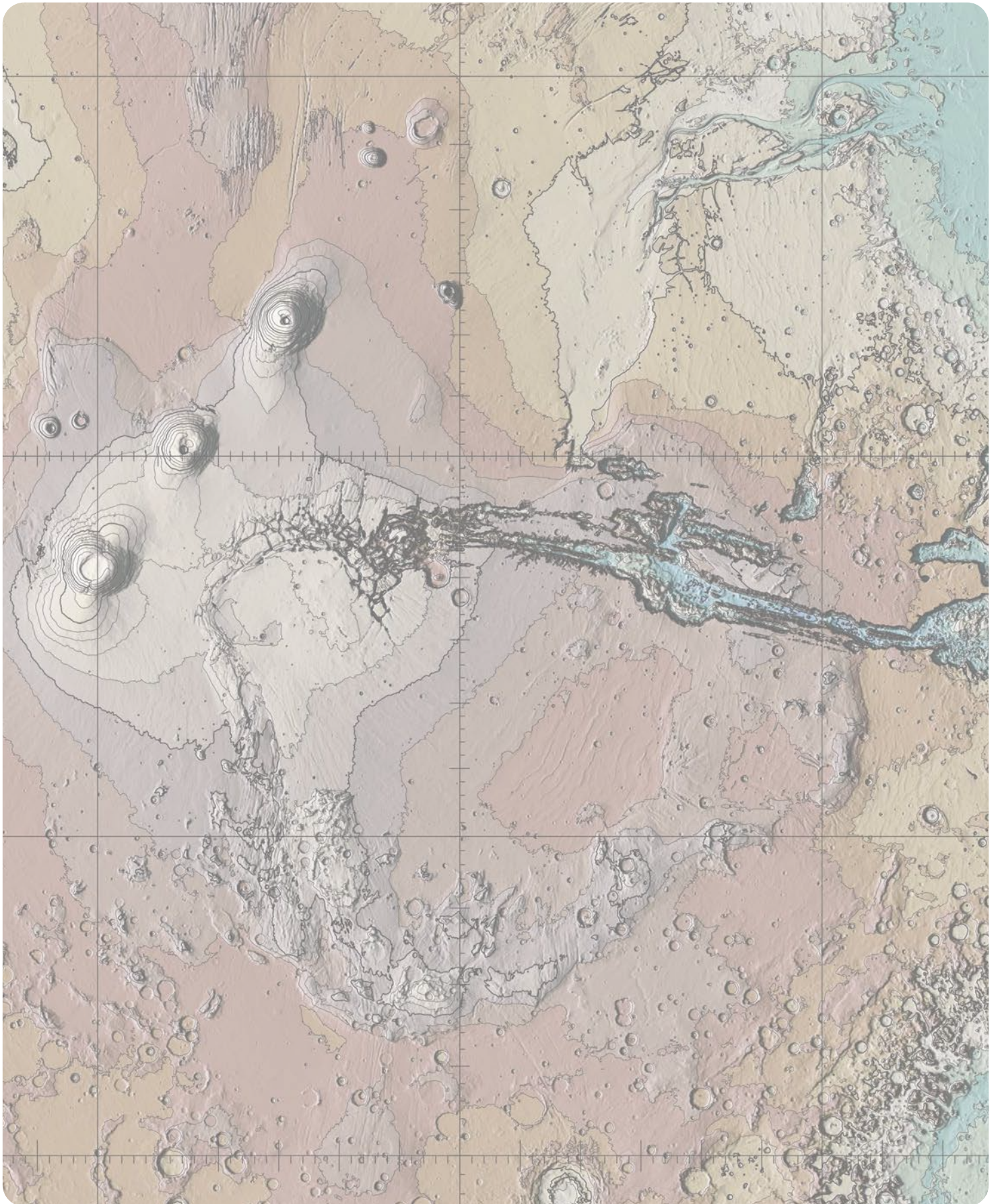
I'd also like to thank the music of Klaus Schulze, a visionary German composer who pioneered early electronic music. I tend to listen to purely 'instrumental' music (anything without significant lyrics) while working on technically difficult projects like this Non-Player system, and Schulze's extensive discography was the perfect accompaniment to *Red Dust Rebellion*, with many of his albums taking inspiration from classic science fiction such as Frank Herbert's *Dune*. His 2005 album *Moonlake* is probably the one that I now most associate with *Red Dust Rebellion*, but really any of his albums would be a good fit for the game. Schulze passed away in 2022, and I would like to dedicate my work on this game to his memory.

Joe Dewhurst

Glasgow, Scotland

February 2024





IMPORTANT CURIOSITY TERMS

1d6, 2d6, 1d3

Die or dice roll to generate a random number. **1d6** means roll the die once; **2d6** means sum two dice, etc. **1d3** means roll one die and halve the result, rounding up.

Activation Number (AN)

A limit on the total number of spaces selected by NP Factions for most Operations. When present, an NP Faction must roll greater than its Activation Number to select another space (8.5.4).

Agitate Total

A measure of NP RD Agitate and Repair capabilities, increased during the NP RD Redistribute Special Activity, and spent during NP RD Repair actions and for Agitate during the Support Phase of each Dust Storm Round.

Asset Total

A measure of NP CR's current 'hand size', increased or reduced whenever any game effect would cause CR to draw or discard Asset cards, and also sometimes reduced when NP CR would otherwise fail an Activation Number roll (simulating them spending an additional Asset card for Resources). The Asset Total may never increase above six (ignore any instructions to increase it beyond this limit).

Critical Event

An Event is Critical for an NP Faction if it is marked with a ★ symbol under the Faction icon. Critical Asset Events are also marked with a ★ symbol.

Effective Event

An Event is Effective if one or more of its effects are listed for the acting NP Faction on the Effective Events table (8.5.5).

Get

Move just enough pieces to the destination to meet the instruction, taking into account any pieces already present in the space. If no additional pieces are needed to meet the instruction, move none. If there are insufficient pieces to meet the instruction, move as many as possible. When a Get instruction might involve several spaces, select the one where it is possible to accomplish as much of the instruction as possible.

Keep

Leave just enough pieces in the origin to meet the instruction. If there are insufficient pieces to meet a particular Keep instruction, ignore it.

Most/Least Support/Opposition

Among all spaces with Support, spaces with the most Support are those with the most total Support. Spaces with the least Support are those with no Support first (Neutral and Opposition spaces), then spaces with the least total Support. Among all spaces with Opposition, spaces with the most Opposition are those with the most total Opposition. Spaces with the least Opposition are those with no Opposition first (Neutral and Support spaces), then spaces with the least total Opposition.

Not Performed Event

An Event is Not Performed by an NP Faction if it is marked with a ⓪ symbol under the Faction icon.

NP

Non-Player.

Populated

A space is Populated if it has at least one Population.

Supply Total

A measure of how many Supply counters have reached Phobos, increased by one for each Supply counter that would otherwise be converted into MG Resources, and sometimes reduced when NP MG would otherwise fail an Activation Number roll (simulating the additional Resources from Supply allowing them to select an additional space for an Operation).

Vulnerable Bases

Any Base in a space with fewer than four friendly units (non-Base forces). MG and CORP units are friendly to each other.

Vulnerable Enemies

Rebel forces that could be removed by an Assault Operation: Active Rebels, and Rebel Bases in spaces without friendly Hidden Rebels.

Within Reach

A space is within reach of moving pieces if those pieces could move to that space with an Operation or Special Activity (including via Spaceports and Maglevs for March and Secure, or via spaces with CR Bases for Travel).

Unpopulated

A space is Unpopulated if it has no Population.